THE MARKETING MANAGEMENT STUDY TEXT

Marketing Management

Unit I • Introduction to Digital Marketing and Content Marketing

IM345AT • Semester IV • Volume 1 of 5

RV College of Engineering, Bengaluru – 59
Department of Industrial Engineering and Management
An Autonomous Institution Affiliated to VTU

THE MARKETING MANAGEMENT STUDY TEXT

Marketing Management

Course Code IM345AT • Semester IV
L:T:P 3:0:0 • 45 Hours • Professional Core Course

UNIT I

Introduction to Digital Marketing and Content Marketing

Principles, channels, personas, research tools, and the complete content marketing engine

Syllabus allocation: 07 Hours

Volume 1 of 5 • Unofficial student study text • 2026 edition

Marketing Management — The Study Text

Volume 1 of 5 • Unit I: Introduction to Digital Marketing and Content Marketing

Prepared for the course Marketing Management (IM345AT), Semester IV, of the Department of Industrial Engineering and Management, RV College of Engineering, Bengaluru – 59.

Sources. The syllabus, course outcomes, assessment rubrics and reference-book list reproduced in the front matter are transcribed from the official course document. The previous-year questions in Appendix B are transcribed from RVCE Continuous Internal Evaluation and Semester End Examination papers for this course, and where an official scheme of valuation was released the model answers follow it. The explanatory text is compiled from classroom lecture notes and, where those were incomplete, from the prescribed reference texts.

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2026 edition.

Preface to Volume 1

Unit I is the foundation of Marketing Management, and it carries a structural privilege that no other unit has: in the Semester End Examination, Question 2 is compulsory and is always set from Unit I. A candidate can choose to avoid one question in each of the other four units. Unit I cannot be avoided. It is also the unit from which the first Continuous Internal Evaluation test is drawn almost in its entirety.

The unit has two halves, and the syllabus names them separately. The first half, *Introduction to Digital Marketing*, establishes what marketing is, what makes digital marketing structurally different from what preceded it, and the practical apparatus of the discipline — its principles, its channels, the buyer persona, and the tools used to research competitors and to analyse a website. The second half, *Content Marketing*, is an engine: an eight-step cycle that runs from goal setting through creation and distribution to measurement and improvement, and then begins again.

Chapters 1 to 6 cover the first half; Chapters 7 to 11 cover the second. The chapter sequence follows the syllabus phrase order exactly, and Appendix A records the mapping.

Two editorial decisions in this volume deserve stating plainly.

First, the syllabus descriptor for Unit I begins at *Introduction to Digital Marketing* and does not separately name the general marketing-management foundations — the mantra of marketing, the entities that can be marketed, needs and wants and demands, the evolution of company orientations, the marketing mix. Past papers for this course nevertheless examine that material inside Unit I, repeatedly and at both two and ten marks. It is therefore treated here as the introductory framing of Chapter 1 rather than as separate content, on the reasoning that one cannot introduce digital marketing without first fixing what marketing is.

Second, a small number of topics appear in past papers for this course but sit outside the literal wording of any unit descriptor: the product life cycle, pricing strategies, and the distinction between market segmentation and the marketing mix. Rather than silently insert them into a numbered chapter — which would breach the rule that the numbered chapters carry the syllabus and nothing else — or silently drop them, which would leave real examined material uncovered, they are set out in Appendix C and flagged there for what they are.

The whole of the course syllabus is reproduced overleaf. The unit covered by this volume is Unit I.

How to Use This Study Text

The shape of a volume

Each of the five volumes in this series covers exactly one unit of the IM345AT syllabus and is self-contained. Every volume opens with the official syllabus for the whole course, so that the unit in hand can always be located within it, and closes with a set of appendices carrying the concordance, the question bank, the glossary and a quick-reference sheet.

The numbered chapters of each volume map one-to-one onto the topic phrases of that unit's official syllabus descriptor. The order of the chapters is the order of the syllabus. Appendix A sets out that mapping explicitly, phrase by phrase, so coverage can be audited rather than assumed.

The five panel types

Material that is not continuous prose is set in one of five panels. Each has a fixed meaning throughout the series.

DEFINITION • the term being defined

A formal definition, worth reproducing close to verbatim in an answer script. The term appears in the panel heading and again in the index.

HIGH YIELD

A result, list or distinction that carries disproportionate examination weight. Where a topic has recurred across papers, the recurrence is recorded as a bracketed tag. (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026)

MODEL ANSWER

An answer written at the length and in the register the marking scheme rewards. Where an official scheme of valuation was released, the panel follows it.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A concrete illustration — a named company, a named persona, a worked calculation — rather than a general statement.

CAUTION

A common and costly error: a distinction usually collapsed, a term usually misused, or an answer that looks complete and is not.

A sixth panel, in green, sets out a framework or process as a single sequence:

FRAMEWORK

Step one → step two → step three → back to step one.

How previous-year questions are recorded

THE BRACKET CONVENTION

A past-paper appearance is recorded **only** as a bracketed source tag attached to the material, never as a sentence of narrative. So the text reads

> Push versus pull marketing. (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026; SEE, Jun/Jul 2025 — 2 M)

and never "this was asked in 2025 and again in 2026". The tag carries the paper, the date and, where the mark allocation is known, the marks. Multiple appearances are separated by semicolons.

The abbreviations used inside tags are:

CIE-I	First Continuous Internal Evaluation test
CIE-II	Second Continuous Internal Evaluation test
CIE-III	Third Continuous Internal Evaluation test
SEE	Semester End Examination
2 M	Mark allocation of the question as printed on the paper

Appendix B of each volume reproduces every past-paper question traced to that unit, in full, grouped by mark weight, each carrying the same bracketed tag.

Cross-references, figures and the index

Cross-references are given as § chapter.section — so § 1.4 is the fourth section of Chapter 1. Every figure in this series is drawn in TEX rather than imported as an image, so the diagrams print at full resolution at any size and use the same typeface as the surrounding text. Figures and tables are listed after the table of contents.

Terms set in ***bold italic*** on first use are indexed. The index at the back of each volume is a real back-of-book index built from those terms, not a repeat of the contents list.

Status of this text

UNOFFICIAL DOCUMENT

This is a student-compiled study text. It is not issued, endorsed or verified by the Department of Industrial Engineering and Management or by RV College of Engineering. The syllabus reproduced in the front matter, the assessment rubrics and the previous-year questions are transcribed from official documents; the explanatory prose around them is not official. Where the source lecture notes were incomplete, gaps have been filled from the prescribed reference texts listed in the front matter. Always cross-check against the official syllabus and your own class notes.

Official Syllabus: IM345AT

Reproduced from the official course document issued by the Department of Industrial Engineering and Management, RV College of Engineering. The text of the five unit descriptors below is the authority against which every chapter of this series is written; nothing outside it appears in the numbered chapters of any volume.

Semester: IV • MARKETING MANAGEMENT

Category: Professional Core Course (Theory)

Course Code	IM345AT	**CIE Marks**	100 Marks
Credits (L:T:P)	3:0:0	**SEE Marks**	100 Marks
Total Hours	45 L	**SEE Duration**	3.00 Hours

UNIT–I 07 Hrs

Introduction to Digital Marketing: Principles of Digital Marketing; Digital Marketing Channels; Tools to Create Buyer Persona; Competitor Research Tools, Website Analysis Tools, etc.

Content Marketing: Content Marketing Concepts & Strategies; Planning, Creating, Distributing & Promoting Content; Optimize Website UX & Landing Pages; Measure Impact; Metrics & Performance; Using Content Research for Opportunities, etc.

UNIT–II 08 Hrs

Social Media Marketing: Introduction; Major Social Media Platforms for Marketing; Developing Data-driven Audience & Campaign Insights; Social Media for Business; Creation & Optimization of Social Media Campaigns, etc.

Search Engine Optimization: Search Engine Optimization Fundamentals; Keywords and SEO Content Plan; SEO & Business Objectives; Writing SEO Content; On-site & off-site SEO; Optimize Organic Search Ranking, etc.

UNIT–III 07 Hrs

Web Analytics & Google Analytics: Google Analytics Tools; Web Analytics Tools, etc.

E-mail Marketing: Effective E-mail Campaigns; E-mail Plan; E-mail Marketing Campaign Analysis; Measuring Conversions & keeping up, etc.

UNIT–IV 07 Hrs

Web Design: Web design, optimization of websites; Publishing a basic website; User-centered Design and Website Optimization; Design Principles and Website Copy; Website Metrics & Developing Insight, etc.

Mobile Marketing: Difference between mobile advertising and marketing, utilizing mobile marketing for sales promotions, online applications, etc.

UNIT–V 07 Hrs

Conversion Optimization: What is AIDAS and its role; website optimization; what visitors want to see on the website; how to optimize key element and increase the effect of landing on a particular page

Digital Analytics: Evolution of Digital Analytics, information about end-to-end customer experience, analyst's influence on business, role as a change agent, etc.

Course Outcomes

After completing the course, the students will be able to:

CO1	Differentiate the benefits drawn by updated marketing mix from traditional marketing mix for effective marketing management there by to stay competitive in today's global market-place.
CO2	Develop an effective holistic marketing atmosphere to efficiently face the challenges in dynamically changing market.
CO3	Formulate a potential marketing plan to effectively reach the targeted market segments, by delivering the value to targeted customers through practicing sound marketing research.
CO4	Create new channels to improvise marketing to achieve and maintain competitive position in globalized market-place.

Prescribed Reference Books

1. *Marketing Management*, Philip Kotler, Kevin Lane Keller, 15th Edition, 2016, Pearson, ISBN: 978-93-325-5718-5.
2. *Digital Marketing — Strategy, Implementation & Practice*, Dave Chaffey, Fiona Ellis-Chadwick, 7th Edition, 2019, Pearson, ISBN: 9781292241623, 1292241624.
3. *Marketing Research*, Donald S. Tull, Del I. Hawkins, 6th Edition, Prentice Hall India, ISBN: 8120309618.
4. *Marketing Management — A South Asian Perspective*, Philip Kotler, Kevin Lane Keller, Abraham Koshy, Mithileshwar Jha, 14th Edition, 2013, Pearson, ISBN: 978-81-317-6716-0.
5. *Marketing Research*, David A. Aaker, V. Kumar, George S. Day, 9th Edition, 2008, John Wiley & Sons, ISBN: 978-265-1791-6.

Assessment Scheme

Rubric for the Continuous Internal Evaluation (Theory)

#	Component	Marks
1.	**Quizzes:** Quizzes will be conducted in online/offline mode. TWO QUIZZES will be conducted & each quiz will be evaluated for 10 marks. The sum of two quizzes will be the final quiz marks.	**20**
2.	**Tests:** Students will be evaluated in test, descriptive questions with different complexity levels (Revised Bloom's Taxonomy Levels: Remembering, Understanding, Applying, Analyzing, Evaluating and Creating). TWO tests will be conducted. Each test will be evaluated for 50 marks, adding up to 100 marks. Final test marks will be reduced to 40 marks.	**40**
3.	**Experiential Learning:** Students will be evaluated for their creativity and practical implementation of the problem. Case study-based teaching learning (10), Program specific requirements (10), Video based seminar/presentation/demonstration (20), adding up to 40.	**40**
MAXIMUM MARKS FOR THE CIE THEORY		**100**

Rubric for the Semester End Examination (Theory)

Q. No.	Contents	Marks
PART A		
1	Objective type questions covering entire syllabus	**20**
PART B	*(Maximum of TWO sub-divisions only)*	
2	Unit 1: (Compulsory)	**16**
3 & 4	Unit 2: (Internal Choice)	**16**
5 & 6	Unit 3: (Internal Choice)	**16**
7 & 8	Unit 4: (Internal Choice)	**16**
9 & 10	Unit 5: (Internal Choice)	**16**
TOTAL		**100**

WHAT THE SEE STRUCTURE MEANS FOR THIS VOLUME

Part A draws twenty marks of objective questions from the *entire* syllabus, so no unit can be skipped. In Part B, Question 2 is compulsory and is always set from Unit I; Units II to V each carry a 16-mark internal-choice pair. A candidate therefore answers Unit I plus one question from each of the remaining four units — five full questions in all.

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CHAPTER 1

Introduction to Digital Marketing

SYLLABUS EXTRACT

Introduction to Digital Marketing.

WHAT THIS CHAPTER COVERS

- What marketing management is, and the mantra that compresses it.
- The ten entities that can be marketed; needs, wants and demands.
- How value is created, delivered and judged — and what satisfaction is.
- Marketplace, market space and the metamarket.
- The five company orientations and the four dimensions of holistic marketing.
- What digital marketing is, and why it is not a separate discipline.
- Traditional marketing, its strengths and its limits, and a costed transition to digital.
- Push marketing against pull marketing.
- The marketing mix, and how each of the four Ps has evolved in the digital era.
- The technologies that made digital marketing possible.
- The digital consumer — the five traits, perceived anonymity, and influencers.

1.1 The Marketing Foundation

Digital marketing is not a separate discipline from marketing. It is marketing conducted through digital channels. Every construct in this volume — personas, content engines, channel mixes, conversion funnels — is a digital expression of something marketing already did. So the foundation has to be secure before anything else, and it is examined as such.

1.1.1 Marketing management defined

> **DEFINITION** • Marketing Management
>
> ***Marketing management*** is the art and science of choosing target markets and getting, keeping and growing customers through creating, delivering and communicating superior customer value.

Three distinct ideas are packed into that sentence, and each carries a consequence.

- **Choosing target markets** is a selection decision. You cannot serve everybody, and the attempt to do so produces an offer that fits nobody.
- **Getting, keeping and growing customers** is a lifecycle view. Acquisition alone is not marketing; a business that acquires well and retains badly is buying the same customer twice.
- **Creating, delivering and communicating superior value** is the actual work — and note the order. Value is created before it is communicated. Communication without created value is advertising a promise you cannot keep.

1.1.2 The mantra of marketing

MODEL ANSWER — 2 MARKS

Create — Communicate — Deliver — Value — Target — Profit. (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025 — 2 M)

The firm *creates* value, *communicates* it to a chosen *target*, *delivers* it, and in return earns *profit*.

1.1.3 Why marketing matters — three pillars

1. **Financial success.** A firm's financial performance often depends directly on its marketing ability. The best operations and the best finance function in the industry are worthless if there is insufficient demand for what the firm makes.
2. **Economic engine.** Successful marketing builds demand for products and services, and that demand creates jobs.
3. **Intangible assets.** Marketing builds strong brands and a loyal customer base, and these contribute heavily to the firm's overall enterprise value — often more than its physical assets do.

1.1.4 Selling is only the tip of the iceberg

Selling and marketing are not synonyms, and the confusion is expensive. Selling is the visible tip. Marketing is the mass below the waterline: research, segmentation, targeting, positioning, product design, pricing, channel design and communication. There will always be a need for some selling, but the aim of marketing is to make selling superfluous.

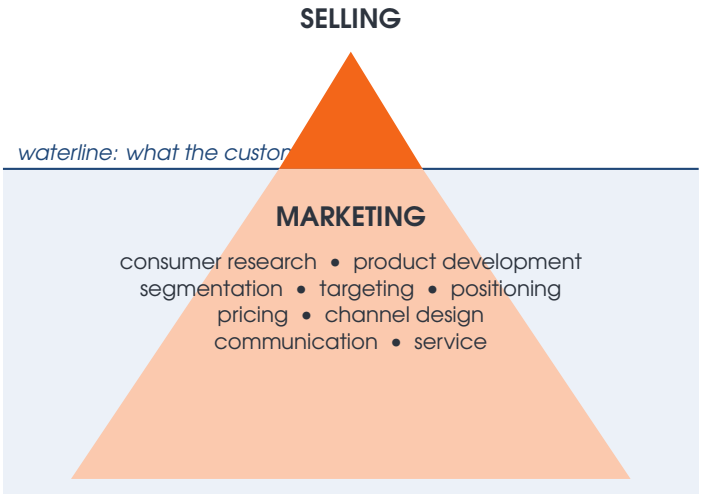


Figure 1.1. Selling is the visible tip; marketing is the submerged mass that makes the tip possible. The aim of the work below the waterline is to reduce how much work the tip has to do.

> *The aim of marketing is to make selling superfluous. The aim is to know and understand the customer so well that the product or service fits him and sells itself. Ideally marketing should result in a customer who is ready to buy. All that should be needed then is to make the product or service available.*
>
> — Peter Drucker

1.1.5 The ten entities that can be marketed

Marketing is not confined to physical products. Ten classes of thing can be marketed, and the official scheme for this course lists exactly ten. (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025 — 10 M)

Table 1.1. The ten entities that can be marketed

Entity	What is marketed	Example
Goods	Physical, tangible products — the bulk of most nations' production	Cars, smartphones, packaged food
Services	Intangible performances that cannot be stored	Airlines, banking, hotels, salons, consultants
Events	Time-based occasions promoted to an audience	Olympics, trade fairs, IPL, company anniversaries
Experiences	Orchestrated combinations of goods and services	Disneyland, adventure treks, escape rooms
Persons	Celebrity and personal branding	Sportspersons, actors, CEOs, political leaders
Places	Cities, states, regions and nations competing for tourists and investment	"Incredible India", Singapore, Dubai
Properties	Intangible rights of ownership, real or financial	Real estate, stocks, bonds
Organizations	The institution itself as a brand	Universities, NGOs, corporate brand campaigns
Information	Production, packaging and distribution of knowledge	Encyclopaedias, magazines, schools, market research
Ideas	Social causes and concepts	"Swachh Bharat", anti-smoking and road-safety campaigns

1.1.6 Needs, wants and demands

DEFINITION • Needs, Wants, Demands

Needs are the basic human requirements — air, food, water, clothing, shelter, and at a higher level recreation, education and entertainment. Needs are not created by marketers.

Wants are needs directed at specific objects that might satisfy them. Wants are shaped by society, culture and individual personality.

Demands are wants for a specific product backed by an ability and willingness to pay.

An Indian consumer *needs* food, *wants* a masala dosa, and *demands* one only if there is money in the pocket. Many people want a Mercedes; only a few can demand one. The distinction matters because it locates the marketer's actual leverage: needs cannot be manufactured, wants can be shaped, and demand can be enabled through pricing, credit and distribution.

CORE CONCEPTS OF MARKETING — 2 MARKS

(CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 2 M) Acceptable answers are any two of: needs, wants, demand, value, exchange, markets. Extended lists also admit target markets, segmentation, positioning, offerings, brands, satisfaction, supply chain, competition and the marketing environment.

1.2 The Value Creation Engine

Value moves through the organisation in three connected steps: decide the audience, build the solution, and measure the result.

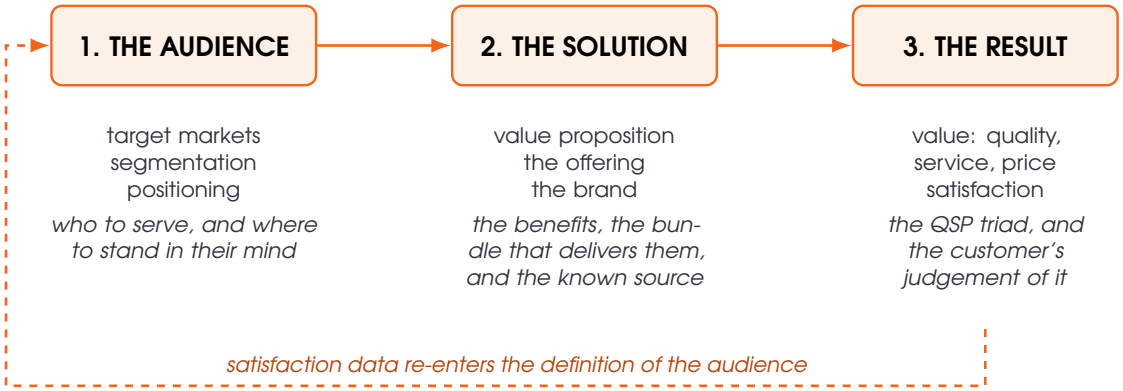


Figure 1.2. The value creation engine. Value is defined by the audience chosen, built into the solution, and judged in the result — and the judgement feeds back into the next definition of the audience.

1. **The audience** — target markets, segmentation and positioning. Identifying who to serve and where to stand in their mind.
2. **The solution** — the ***value proposition*** (the set of benefits offered to satisfy the need), the ***offering*** (the combination of products, services, information and experiences that delivers it), and the ***brand*** (an offering from a known source).
3. **The result** — value (the combination of quality, service and price, the *QSP triad*) and ***satisfaction*** (a person's judgement of a product's perceived performance compared with expectations).

1.2.1 Satisfaction, and the difference between satisfied and delighted

THE SATISFACTION RULE

If performance $<$ expectations, the customer is **dissatisfied**.
If performance $=$ expectations, the customer is **satisfied**.
If performance $>$ expectations, the customer is **delighted**.

Delight, not mere satisfaction, is what produces advocacy. A satisfied customer got what was promised and owes you nothing; a delighted customer got more than was promised and tells people so. This asymmetry is why the whole of earned media (§ 3.2) rests on exceeding expectations rather than meeting them.

1.2.2 Marketplace, market space and the metamarket

DEFINITION • Marketplace and Market Space

A ***marketplace*** is a physical or digital location where buyers and sellers come together to exchange goods and services. It is concrete — a mall, a mandi, a showroom.

A ***market space*** is a conceptual or virtual environment in which commercial value is created through digital networks and communication technologies. It is abstract and has no geography — Amazon, an app, a marketplace platform.



Figure 1.3. The satisfaction scale. Only the third band generates earned media; the second merely avoids losing the customer.

> **HIGH YIELD**
>
> One-line contrast for a two-mark answer: **marketplace = physical; market space = digital.** (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 2 M each)

A third, related term completes the set. A ***metamarket*** is a cluster of complementary products and services that are closely related in the mind of the consumer but spread across different industries. The automobile metamarket contains manufacturers, dealers, insurers, financiers, service centres and auto magazines — none of which is in the same industry, all of which are in the same purchase.

1.3 Company Orientations and Holistic Marketing

1.3.1 The evolution of company orientations

Table 1.2. The five company orientations

Orientation	Central belief	Focus
Production concept	Consumers prefer products that are widely available and inexpensive	Manufacturing efficiency, mass distribution, low cost
Product concept	Consumers favour products offering the most quality, performance or innovative features	Continuous product improvement
Selling concept	Consumers will not buy enough unless prodded	Aggressive promotion and a large sales force — the tip of the iceberg
Marketing concept	Find the right products for your customers, not the right customers for your products	Customer needs, integrated marketing, profitability through satisfaction
Holistic marketing	Everything matters in marketing, and a broad, integrated perspective is necessary	Internal, integrated, performance and relationship marketing

> **DO NOT COLLAPSE THE MIDDLE TWO**
>
> The product concept and the selling concept are routinely confused. The product concept believes a *better* product will sell itself, and fails through engineering-led blindness to what customers actually

want. The selling concept believes *any* product will sell if pushed hard enough, and fails through churn — it can move the first unit but never the second.

1.3.2 Holistic marketing — four dimensions

- **Internal marketing** — aligning the marketing department, senior management and every other department so that the whole firm embraces marketing principles.
- **Integrated marketing** — designing communications, products and services, channels and price so that they reinforce rather than contradict one another.
- **Performance marketing** — measuring returns: sales revenue, brand equity and customer equity, plus the ethical, environmental, legal and social effects of marketing activity.
- **Relationship marketing** — building deep, enduring relationships with the four constituents who sustain the business: customers, employees, marketing partners and the financial community.

1.3.3 The eight marketing management tasks

THE EIGHT TASKS

1. Developing market strategies and plans → 2. Capturing marketing insights → 3. Connecting with customers → 4. Building strong brands → 5. Creating value → 6. Delivering value → 7. Communicating value → 8. Creating successful long-term growth — which loops back to task 1.

1.3.4 The market ecosystem and the profit equation

An *industry* is a collection of sellers; a *market* is a collection of buyers. Sellers send communication and goods and services to the market; buyers send back money and information. The whole loop resolves into one equation.

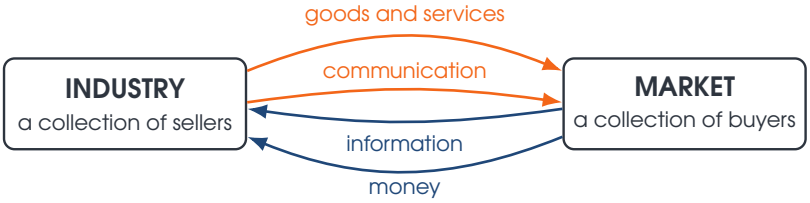


Figure 1.4. The exchange loop. Two flows out, two flows back. Marketing manages all four.

THE PROFIT EQUATION

$$\text{Profit} = \text{Revenues} - \text{Costs}$$

Every marketing decision either raises revenue — more customers, a higher price, more purchases per customer — or lowers cost — cheaper acquisition, better retention, more efficient channels. If it does neither, it is not marketing. It is decoration.

Two further constructs complete the ecosystem.

Supply chain The longer channel stretching from raw materials through components to finished products carried to final buyers. For coffee: Ethiopian farmers grow and harvest, then sell to a Fair Trade cooperative; the beans are washed, dried and packaged; an Alternative Trading

Organisation transports them; and they are sold through retail channels. Each link captures a share of the total value.

Competition All the actual and potential rival offerings and substitutes a buyer might consider — not merely direct competitors, but anything competing for the same need and the same rupee.

1.4 What Digital Marketing Is

DEFINITION • Digital Marketing

Digital marketing is the well-targeted, conversion-oriented, quantifiable and interactive marketing of products or services using digital technologies, in order to reach customers, convert them into clients and retain them in a sustainable fashion.

Four words in that definition do the work. *Well-targeted*: the audience can be specified rather than approximated. *Conversion-oriented*: the objective is a defined action, not an impression. *Quantifiable*: every step leaves a data trail. *Interactive*: the audience can answer back.

Through digital channels a business does not merely share its products and services online. It can attract prospects, engage them, and convert them into paying customers, while measuring every step. The speed and simplicity with which digital media transmits information and supports a business is what makes it structurally different from everything that came before.

The world is now super-connected, and marketing and advertising are no longer what they once were. This is particularly true because of the rise of social networking, which changed how organisations speak with potential and existing customers. Digital marketing is an aggregate term, used where advertising and marketing meet web technology and online media platforms.

THE CENTRAL IDEA OF THIS COURSE

"Digital marketing isn't about technology; it's about people." Technology is only interesting, from a marketing perspective, when it connects people with other people more effectively. Understanding the underlying code is secondary. Understanding the human being on the other side of the screen is the job.

1.5 Traditional Marketing and the Transition to Digital

1.5.1 Traditional marketing

Traditional marketing lets businesses promote their products or services on print media, radio and television commercials, billboards, business cards and numerous similar channels where the internet and social platforms are not used. It is, in effect, everything except digital means of branding a product.

- Traditional approaches had constrained reach and limited scope to influence buying behaviour, and they were not quantifiable.
- Tangible forms include business cards, print advertisements in newspapers and magazines, posters, brochures, television and radio commercials, and billboards.
- An often overlooked form is **referral and networking** — people find a business through a referral and a rapport is built over time.
- Because of its longevity, people are accustomed to it. Reading a billboard or spotting an advertisement in a magazine remain familiar everyday activities.
- It usually reaches a local audience, though it is not strictly limited to one.

WHERE TRADITIONAL MARKETING STILL WINS

Targeting a genuinely local audience; materials the customer physically keeps and returns to; a more personal feel in a high-trust sale; and a simpler process with fewer moving parts and no platform dependency.

Its primary weaknesses are the mirror image. Results are not easily measured and often cannot be measured at all. It is generally more costly. And it is static — there is no way to interact with the audience. You are throwing information in front of people and hoping they act.

1.5.2 Traditional marketing against digital marketing

HIGH YIELD

This comparison is examined at both ten and eight marks. Learn at least seven rows and keep one example per row. (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025 — 10 M; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 10 M; SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q2a — 8 M)

Table 1.3. Traditional marketing against digital marketing

Aspect	Traditional Marketing	Digital Marketing
Communication	Unidirectional — the organisation talks at its audience	Bidirectional — customers ask questions, complain and make suggestions back
Medium	Phone calls, letters, print, television, radio, billboards	Social media, websites, chat, apps, e-mail, SEO, PPC
Reach	Local, or mass depending on medium; geographically restricted	Global and theoretically infinite, yet laser-targeted
Cost	Often expensive — television, print production, media buying	Cost-effective — pay-per-click and organic reach options
Targeting	Broad and imprecise	Precise — age, location, interests, behaviour, intent
Interactivity	One-way communication	Two-way, real-time engagement
Measurability	Hard to track ROI accurately; largely unquantifiable	Easily trackable with analytics and KPIs, in real time
Flexibility	Less flexible once launched; rigid, long-term campaigns	Highly flexible; adjustable in real time
Time to launch	Requires long planning and production cycles	Quick to launch, refine and adapt
Direction of pull	Outbound — push	Inbound — the goal is for people to find you

1.5.3 A strategy for transitioning from traditional to digital

MODEL ANSWER — 10 MARKS

(CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 10 M) A complete answer states the benefits and limitations of both approaches — use Table 1.3 — and then commits to a sequenced transition.

1. **Start with a hybrid approach.** Run both in parallel initially rather than cutting traditional spend overnight. Cutting first destroys known demand before the replacement exists.
2. **Build the owned foundation.** A quality company website and a social media presence, because every later step needs somewhere to send traffic.
3. **Layer on SEO and content marketing.** Blogs, videos and landing pages, to build compounding organic traffic.
4. **Run targeted paid advertising.** Google Ads and social advertising to buy immediate reach while the organic asset builds.
5. **Leverage e-mail marketing and influencers** for retention and borrowed credibility respectively.
6. **Track performance with analytics tools**, defining the KPIs *before* launch rather than after.
7. **Gradually reduce traditional spending** based on measured results, not on assumption.
8. **Upskill or hire.** Train the existing team or bring in a dedicated digital marketing expert.

Limitations to name for digital, so the answer is balanced: it requires technical skills; online competition is high; there are privacy and data-protection concerns; and it depends on internet access.

1.6 Push and Pull Marketing

THE SINGLE MOST REPEATED TWO-MARK QUESTION

Push against pull is the most repeated short question in this course. Learn the definitions close to verbatim and keep two examples ready. (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026; SEE, Jun/Jul 2025 — 2 M each)

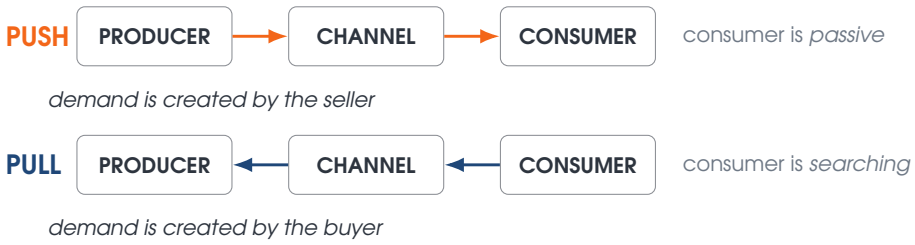


Figure 1.5. Push and pull differ in the direction of initiative, and therefore in who creates the demand.

Table 1.4. Push marketing against pull marketing

Basis	Push Marketing	Pull Marketing
Definition	The brand pushes the product towards the customer	The brand encourages customers to actively seek it out
Direction	Producer → channel → consumer	Consumer → producer
Typical tools	Television and print advertising, trade discounts, dealer incentives, direct selling, telemarketing, point-of-sale displays	SEO, content marketing, social media, word of mouth, brand building, public relations
Consumer state	Passive; unaware of the need	Active; already searching

Basis	Push Marketing	Pull Marketing
Demand created by	The seller	The buyer
Cost pattern	High recurring spend; stops when spend stops	High upfront effort; compounds over time
Best for	New products, impulse goods, low-involvement purchases	Established brands, high-involvement and considered purchases

1.7 The Marketing Mix in the Digital Era

1.7.1 The four Ps

DEFINITION • Marketing Mix

The ***marketing mix*** is the set of controllable tactical tools that a firm blends to produce the response it wants from its chosen target market: Product, Price, Place and Promotion.



Figure 1.6. The four Ps are the controllable levers; the target market is what they are aimed at. Changing the target changes every lever.

1.7.2 How the four Ps have evolved in the digital era

Table 1.5. The digital evolution of the four Ps

P	Digital evolution	Company example
Product	Digital and personalised products; customisable, data-driven, and increasingly delivered in digital formats — software, online services, virtual goods	Spotify uses listening data to generate personalised playlists, making the product itself different for every user
Price	Dynamic and transparent pricing; real-time price changes, personalised offers, and instant comparison by the customer	Amazon adjusts prices dynamically using demand, competition and user behaviour

P	Digital evolution	Company example
Place	Online channels and omnichannel presence; a shift from physical stores to e-commerce, apps and marketplaces with a seamless online–offline experience	Nike links its website, mobile app and physical stores through click-and-collect and a store locator
Promotion	Digital and interactive marketing; a shift from mass media to targeted digital campaigns, social media, influencer and content marketing	Coca-Cola's "Share a Coke" campaign ran as interactive, personalised, shareable digital content

EXAMINED AS

"How have the 4Ps of marketing evolved in the digital era? Provide examples of companies effectively leveraging digital strategies for each element." (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025 — 10 M) Answer with Table 1.5, one named company per P, and close by naming the service extensions below.

1.7.3 The seven Ps and the four Cs

Two standard extensions complete the framework.

- The **seven Ps of services marketing** add three service-specific levers to the original four: **People** (everyone who touches the customer), **Process** (the sequence the customer is put through) and **Physical evidence** (the tangible cues that make an intangible service credible).
- The **four Cs** are the customer-side mirror of the four Ps: **Customer solution** for Product, **Customer cost** for Price, **Convenience** for Place and **Communication** for Promotion. The relabelling is not cosmetic — it forces each lever to be stated from the buyer's point of view rather than the seller's.

1.8 The Technology Behind Digital Marketing

Developments in technology and the evolution of marketing are inextricably intertwined, and the adoption pattern is always the same.

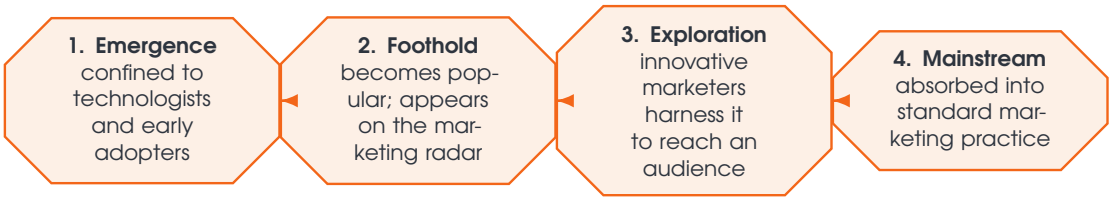


Figure 1.7. The four-step adoption pattern. The printing press, radio, television and the internet each ran the same course.

The printing press, radio, television and now the internet are all breakthroughs that permanently altered the relationship between marketers and consumers, on a global scale.

1.8.1 Timeline — from Sputnik to the World Wide Web

Table 1.6. The enabling technologies of digital marketing

Year	Milestone	Why it matters to marketers
1957	The USSR launches Sputnik	Signals that the United States is falling behind; triggers heavy US investment in science and technology
1958	The US Department of Defense sets up ARPA, the Advanced Research Projects Agency	The institutional parent of the internet
early 1960s	E-mail exists only within single mainframes	The killer application is born, but cannot yet cross machines
1971	Ray Tomlinson writes the first program to send mail between host computers on ARPANET, choosing the `@` symbol to separate user from host	E-mail becomes a network application — as a programmer's afterthought
1974	Vinton Cerf, the "father of the internet", and Robert Kahn define the TCP protocol at DARPA	Different networks can now be interconnected
1983	ARPANET adopts TCP/IP; the domain name system is invented (`.com`, `.net`)	Widely considered the true birth of the internet
1984–89	Nodes pass one thousand, then one hundred thousand hosts	Network effects begin
1989	Tim Berners-Lee at CERN proposes cross-referencing documents across the internet using hypertext	The concept of the World Wide Web
6 Aug 1991	The first web page goes online at CERN	The web becomes a public medium
2000s on	The dot-com boom, then Web 2.0	User-generated content; the global village

HOW TO FRAME THIS ANSWER

If asked about the technology behind digital marketing, structure the answer in three parts rather than listing dates: (i) the four-step adoption pattern of Figure 1.7; (ii) the timeline of enabling technologies from Table 1.6; and (iii) the present-day stack — websites and content management systems, search engines and their ranking algorithms, social platforms and their feed algorithms, analytics and tag management, e-mail service providers and CRM, mobile devices and apps, cloud infrastructure, and increasingly machine learning for personalisation and pricing.

1.9 Understanding the Digital Consumer

1.9.1 The myth and the reality

There is a notion in marketing circles of mysterious, ethereal creatures who exist in a hyper-connected cyber-world of their own — enigmas who speak a different language and are turning marketing on its head. The first thing to realise about digital consumers is that there is basically no such thing. The customers encountered online are the very same people who walk into the store, telephone, or order from the catalogue.

They are doing exactly what people have done for thousands of years: communicating with each other. That technology lets them do it faster, over distance and across devices is perceived

as dangerous and extraordinary, but people have always talked to each other. What has genuinely changed is *consumer behaviour*, and it changed because of the pervasive, evocative and enabling nature of digital technology.

THE CONSUMER DOES NOT SHARE YOUR TAXONOMY

Consumers do not care how marketers categorise their work. Above the line, below the line, digital, traditional, experiential, linear, analogue, mobile, direct, indirect — all of these boxes are meaningless to them. All consumers care about is the experience, and whether the marketing available to them helps them make a more informed decision.

1.9.2 Perceived anonymity

Perceived anonymity is an online trait with a profound effect on behaviour. It liberates consumers from the social shackles that bind them in the physical world; online they act with scant regard for the social propriety that holds sway in real life.

In a physical store, shoppers wait patiently for service and will endure a less-than-perfect experience to get what they want. Online they will not. They demand instant gratification and a flawless experience, and if you fail to engage, retain and fulfil their expectations on demand they are gone — the only trace a solitary line in the server log.

1.9.3 The five key traits of the online consumer

Table 1.7. The five traits of the online consumer

Trait	What it means	What the marketer must therefore do
1. Comfortable with the medium	Users have been online for years and are increasingly web-savvy across all age groups; they use it efficiently and do not hang around	Deliver what they want, fast; write scannable content
2. They want it all, and they want it now	Accustomed to information on demand from multiple sources simultaneously; their time is precious	Design for scannability and instant gratification; front-load the value
3. They are in control	The web is no passive medium; Web 2.0 put users firmly in charge	Make marketing user-centric, elective and permission-based, with a real value proposition
4. They are fickle	Transparency and immediacy erode brand loyalty; competitors are one click and one search away	Build genuine trust; make sure the total value proposition stacks up globally, not just the brand identity
5. They are vocal	Through reviews, blogs, social networks, forums and communities they tell each other about good and bad experiences	Harness the viral upside; monitor and respond, because the same mechanism produces a backlash

1.9.4 Consumer 2.0 — how Web 2.0 rewired behaviour

- **Inter-connectivity** — borderless peer-to-peer communication through social networks.
- **On-demand** — instant gratification, anytime and anywhere.

- **Levelled information** — unbiased research is freely available, shifting power decisively to the buyer.
- **Rise of the *prosumer*** — customers now help shape and even dictate the products they consume.
- **Relevance filtering** — users block noise and customise their own feeds; irrelevant marketing is simply never seen.
- **Niche aggregation** — mass markets fragment into thousands of micro-communities.
- **Micropublishing** — anyone can publish opinions, reviews and blogs instantly.

1.9.5 Online influencers

DEFINITION • Influencer

An ***influencer*** is an early adopter and online opinion leader who, through blogs, podcasts, forums and social networks, extols the virtues of brands they like and denigrates those they find unsatisfactory.

Influencers matter because they hold the virtual ear of the online masses. People read them, value their opinion and trust their judgement. Engage positively and you recruit a team of powerful advocates; give them a negative experience and the reverse happens, at the same scale. This is word-of-mouth marketing on steroids.

THE DOUBLECLICK TEST FOR RECOGNISING AN INFLUENCER

A person qualifies as an influencer if they strongly agree with three or more of the following.

- They consider themselves expert in certain areas — work, hobbies or interests.
- People often ask their advice about purchases in areas where they are knowledgeable.
- When they encounter a new product they like, they tend to recommend it to friends.
- They have a large social circle and often refer people to one another based on interests.
- They are active online, using blogs, social networking sites, e-mail, discussion groups and community boards to connect with peers.

WHY WORD OF MOUTH DOMINATES

Roughly 90% of people believe what their peers say about a brand, while only about 48% trust what businesses say directly. Americans value word-of-mouth recommendations from friends and family about 41% more than social media recommendations. This asymmetry is the entire economic case for content marketing, influencer marketing and community building — and the reason earned media (§ 3.2) is treated as the most credible of the three media types.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Marketing management chooses target markets and gets, keeps and grows customers by creating, delivering and communicating superior value; the mantra compresses this to create, communicate, deliver, value, target, profit. Ten classes of entity can be marketed. Needs are not created by marketers, wants are shaped, and demand requires ability to pay. Value is defined by the audience, built into the solution and judged in the result; performance above expectation produces delight and therefore advocacy. A marketplace is physical, a market space is digital, a metamarket spans industries. Firms have evolved through production, product, selling and marketing concepts to holistic marketing. Digital marketing is targeted, conversion-oriented, quantifiable and interactive marketing through digital technologies —

not a separate discipline, and not fundamentally about technology. Traditional marketing wins on local reach and physical persistence and loses on measurement, cost and interactivity; the transition to digital is sequenced, hybrid and measurement-led. Push originates with the seller, pull with the buyer. Each of the four Ps has a digital form. The consumer has not changed; consumer behaviour has — and the five traits, perceived anonymity and the influencer are the practical consequences.

CHAPTER 2

Principles of Digital Marketing

SYLLABUS EXTRACT

Principles of Digital Marketing.

WHAT THIS CHAPTER COVERS

- The five foundational pillars on which any digital strategy rests.
- The internet paradox — broadening reach and narrowing focus at once.
- The seven governing principles: measurability, interactivity, personalisation, permission, integration, iteration, content centrality.
- The six elements common to successful digital marketing campaigns.

HIGH YIELD

This chapter answers a recurring ten-mark question in full and a two-mark question in one line. (CIE-I, 1 Jul 2024 — 10 M; SEE, Oct/Nov 2023 — 2 M)

2.1 The Five Foundational Pillars

There is no one-size-fits-all digital strategy. Every business must bake its own, and the best people to define it are the people who best know the business. But every workable digital strategy rests on the same five foundations, and each is a question rather than an assertion.

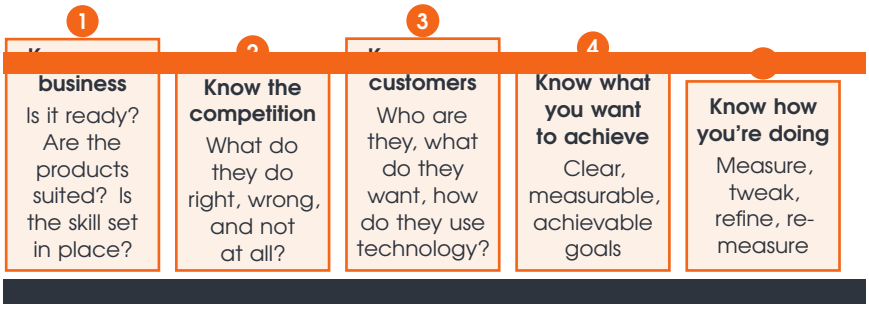


Figure 2.1. The five pillars. Remove any one and the strategy rests on an assumption rather than on knowledge.

1. **Know your business.** Is the business ready to embrace digital marketing? Are the products or services suited to online promotion? Is the right technology, skill set and infrastructure in place? How will digital marketing fit into existing business processes — do those processes need to change, and are the staff ready for that change?

2. **Know the competition.** Who are the main competitors in the digital marketplace, and are they the same as the offline ones? What are they doing right, so it can be emulated; what are they doing wrong, so it can be learned from; and what are they not doing at all — because that is the opportunity. Competition online can come from around the corner or around the globe, so never limit the analysis to local rivals.
3. **Know your customers.** Who are they and what do they want? Are you serving the same customer base online, or fishing in a new demographic? How do they use digital technology, and how can that be harnessed into an ongoing relationship?
4. **Know what you want to achieve.** If you don't know where you're going, you will never get there. Set clear, measurable, achievable goals — online sales, targeted leads, brand awareness — because goals are the yardsticks against which campaign progress is measured.
5. **Know how you're doing.** Everything online is trackable. Which channels deliver traffic? What are the conversion rates? How much of that traffic becomes tangible value? Measure, tweak, refine, re-measure.

2.2 The Internet Paradox

THE INTERNET PARADOX

Unlike conventional mass media, the internet is unique in its capacity to **both broaden the scope of marketing reach and narrow its focus at the same time**. Digital channels let a firm transcend geography and time zones to reach a far wider audience, while simultaneously honing the message with laser-like precision onto very specific niche segments within that wider market. Implemented well, it is an extraordinarily powerful combination.

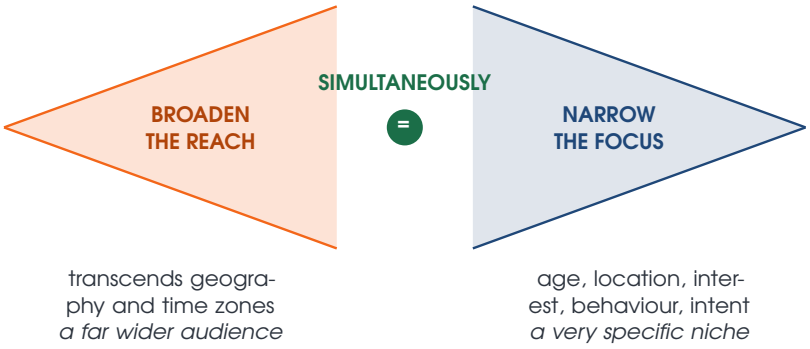


Figure 2.2. The internet paradox. Conventional mass media forces a choice between reach and precision; digital channels do not.

2.3 The Governing Principles

- **Measurability** — every interaction leaves a quantifiable data trail. If it cannot be measured, it should not be a channel.
- **Interactivity** — marketing in the digital age is a dialogue, as much about listening as about telling.
- **Personalisation** — digital marketing allows uniquely tailored, ongoing relationships with individual customers rather than an undifferentiated mass.

- **Permission and user control** — the web is not a passive medium. Marketing must be user-centric, elective and permission-based, or the audience will actively disengage.
- **Integration** — channels must reinforce one another; a siloed campaign wastes the compounding effect.
- **Iteration** — digital marketing is never finished. It is a continuous engine.
- **Content centrality** — content is king. Produce powerful, genuine, compelling content and in time that content becomes the biggest promoter of the brand.

THE ITERATION LOOP

Execute strategy → measure analytics → tweak campaigns → refine goals → execute strategy.

TWO-MARK ANSWER

"List any two principles of digital marketing." (SEE, Oct/Nov 2023 — 2 M) Any two of the five pillars — know your business; know the competition; know your customers; know what you want to achieve; know how you're doing — or any two of measurability, interactivity, personalisation and permission-based targeting. Either set scores.

2.4 Characteristics of a Successful Digital Marketing Campaign

Campaigns differ enormously, but successful ones are built on the same few elements.

1. **A quality company website.** What was a novelty a decade ago is a critical requirement today. A business website is a pseudo-B2B portal that lets businesses and customers around the world connect with you — a company brochure available around the clock that projects the firm as a professional outfit.
2. **Social media presence.** Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn, X, Pinterest and YouTube let a firm communicate across wide demographics of age, taste and culture. By actively promoting the company there, you get the world to talk about you.
3. **Blogging and forums.** Produce genuine, compelling content on the company blog and be a regular on relevant forums and discussion panels. Learn the art of connecting business themes into the content produced.
4. **Local listing services.** Register on Google Business Profile so the business appears in Google searches and on Google Maps; also list on Bing Places and equivalent directories. Joining is free and the reach translates into free promotion.
5. **E-mail marketing.** Done well and with good intentions, personalised e-mail speaks directly to the target audience, produces an immediate response and opens a line of communication with prospects — fast, cheap promotion with measurable feedback.
6. **A dedicated digital marketing expert.** Hiring a professional lets management stay on top of promotional ideas while someone qualified implements the concepts that drive the expected results.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Five pillars found any digital strategy: know your business, the competition, your customers, your goals and your results. The internet paradox is that digital channels broaden reach and narrow focus simultaneously, which conventional mass media cannot do. Seven principles govern execution — measurability, interactivity, personalisation, permission, integration, iteration and content centrality —

and iteration means the work is never finished. Six elements recur in successful campaigns: a quality website, social presence, blogging and forums, local listings, e-mail marketing and dedicated expertise.

CHAPTER 3

Digital Marketing Channels

SYLLABUS EXTRACT

Digital Marketing Channels.

WHAT THIS CHAPTER COVERS

- The three senses in which marketing uses the word "channel".
- The paid, owned and earned media taxonomy, and what each is for.
- The campaign ecosystem as a hub with spokes, and the job of each spoke.
- Affiliate marketing — definition, payment models, advantages and risks.
- How to choose between SEO, PPC and social media on a limited budget.

3.1 The Three Senses of "Channel"

Before listing platforms, note that *channel* in marketing has three distinct senses, and a question about channels may mean any of them.

- **Communication channels** deliver messages to, and receive messages from, target buyers.
- **Distribution channels** display, sell or deliver the physical product or service to the buyer.
- **Service channels** carry out transactions with prospective buyers — warehouses, transporters, banks, payment gateways, insurers.

3.2 Paid, Owned and Earned Media

This is the single most useful way to classify digital channels, and it is examined directly. (CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 10 M)

Table 3.1. Paid, owned and earned media

Media type	Definition	Examples	Role
Owned	Assets entirely controlled by the brand	Company website, blog, mobile app, e-mail list, brand social profiles, brochures	The foundation — no rent, full control, compounds over time
Paid	Capital deployed for guaranteed reach	Display advertising, paid search and PPC, social media advertising, sponsorships, magazine and television advertising, influencer promotions	The accelerator — instant reach, stops the moment spending stops

Media type	Definition	Examples	Role
Earned	Audience-driven reach that was not paid for	Word of mouth, buzz, viral sharing, press coverage, reviews, influencer mentions, backlinks	The validator — most credible, least controllable

RENTED AGAINST OWNED — THE APPLE TREE RULE

Advertising is a rented treadmill. Content is an owned asset. The moment payment for advertising stops, traffic falls to zero; content keeps working.

The apple tree rule: it takes time to plant the seed and grow the tree, but once mature that single tree bears fruit for years without anyone having to buy the apples.

3.3 The Campaign Ecosystem — Hub and Spokes

A coherent digital campaign is not a list of disconnected activities. It is a hub-and-spoke system whose hub is a quality company website — the round-the-clock portal and the ultimate conversion destination. Every other channel exists to feed it.

Table 3.2. The job of each spoke

Spoke	Primary job
Search Engine Optimisation	Capture high-intent organic demand and drive it to the hub
Search Engine Marketing / PPC	Buy immediate visibility on high-value commercial queries
Social Media Marketing	Manage global chatter, build awareness, and engineer community
Content Marketing — blogging and forums	Produce the compelling, genuine material that every other channel distributes
E-mail Marketing	Own the relationship; deliver personalised, rapid-response communication
Affiliate Marketing	Pay partners only for results — traffic, leads or sales actually delivered
Display and Network Advertising	Build reach and remarket to prior visitors
Mobile Marketing	Reach the customer on the device that is always with them
Video Marketing	Build trust and dwell time; dual search-and-social distribution
Local Listings	Be discoverable in "near me" and map searches
Influencer Marketing	Borrow trust that the brand has not yet earned

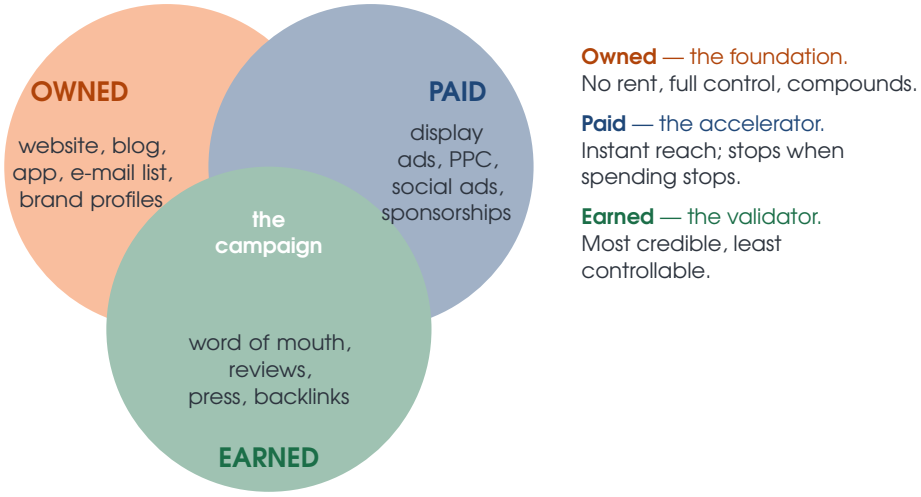


Figure 3.1. Every digital channel is paid, owned or earned. A campaign that uses only one of the three is either renting all its reach, talking only to people it already has, or hoping.

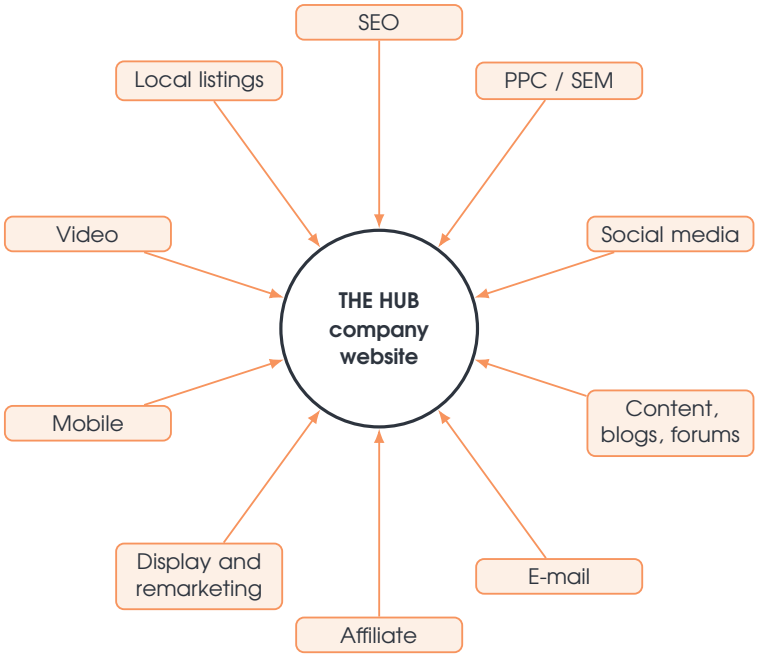


Figure 3.2. The hub-and-spoke campaign ecosystem. Every spoke has one job: to deliver qualified attention to the hub, where conversion happens.

3.4 Affiliate Marketing

DEFINITION • Affiliate Marketing

Affiliate marketing is a type of performance-based marketing in which a business rewards affiliates — partners or individuals — for driving traffic, leads or sales to the company's products or services through the affiliate's own marketing efforts. (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025 — 2 M)

AMAZON ASSOCIATES

A blogger places a tracked Amazon link inside a product review and earns a commission on every purchase made through it. Amazon pays nothing for the review itself, nothing for the traffic that does not convert, and a fixed percentage on the traffic that does.

- **Payment models.** CPA — cost per acquisition or sale; CPL — cost per lead; CPC — cost per click.
- **Advantages.** Risk is transferred to the affiliate, because payment follows results; reach extends into audiences the brand does not own; and costs are variable rather than fixed.
- **Risks.** Brand-safety exposure if affiliates use aggressive or misleading tactics; potential for fraud; and margin erosion if commissions are set too high.

3.5 Choosing Between Channels

THE SCENARIO QUESTION

"Your company has a limited marketing budget and needs to choose between Search Engine Optimization, Pay Per Click, and Social Media Marketing to promote a new product. Based on the product being a high-tech gadget aimed at young professionals, which channel(s) would you prioritize and why?" (CIE-I, 1 Jul 2024 — 10 M)

A strong answer compares the three on a fixed set of criteria and *then commits* to a recommendation. A comparison without a recommendation loses marks.

Table 3.3. SEO, PPC and social media marketing compared

Criterion	SEO	PPC	Social Media Marketing
Speed of results	Slow — months	Immediate	Fast for reach, slow for trust
Cost model	Free per click; costs time and resources	Charged per click; stops when the budget stops	Organic free; paid boosts optional
Longevity	Infinite — compounds	Zero — ends with the campaign	Short, hours to days per post
Buyer intent	High — the user is actively searching	High — keyword-triggered	Low to medium — interruption-based
Predictability	High once established	High	Low — relies on viral spikes

Criterion	SEO	PPC	Social Media Marketing
Best suited to	Long-term compounding demand	Launches, promotions, high-margin conversions	Awareness, community, visual products

MODEL RECOMMENDATION

For a high-tech gadget aimed at young professionals on a limited budget:

- **about 50% to PPC and paid social** for the launch window. The product is new, so nobody is searching for it by name yet — organic search cannot deliver demand that does not exist.
- **about 30% to social media marketing**, weighted to Instagram, YouTube and LinkedIn, because young professionals discover technology through video reviews and peer validation.
- **about 20% to SEO and content** — comparison articles, specification pages, "best gadget for X" content — as the compounding asset that reduces paid dependence over the following two quarters.

Justify with the intent argument: PPC and social *create* the demand; SEO *harvests* it once it exists. That single sentence is what distinguishes a first-class answer from a list.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Channel means communication, distribution or service. Every digital channel is paid, owned or earned: owned is the foundation, paid the accelerator, earned the validator. A campaign is a hub of one quality website fed by spokes, each with a single job. Affiliate marketing pays only for delivered results, on CPA, CPL or CPC terms, transferring risk at the cost of brand-safety exposure. Channel choice is decided by speed, cost model, longevity, buyer intent and predictability — and a scenario answer must end in a weighted recommendation justified by buyer intent.

CHAPTER 4

Tools to Create a Buyer Persona

SYLLABUS EXTRACT

Tools to Create Buyer Persona.

WHAT THIS CHAPTER COVERS

- What a buyer persona is, and how many a business needs.
- The five-step process for building one, in the order the scheme expects.
- The seven factor categories to capture, with an illustration throughout.
- The persona builder canvas — four quadrants of questions.
- A complete worked persona.
- The toolset, and the division of labour between hard data and listening.

THE MOST REPEATED TEN-MARK QUESTION IN THIS COURSE

The adventure-tourism travel agency scenario is set verbatim in two separate papers. Learn the process, the factors, and be ready to invent a named example persona on the spot. (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025 — 10 M; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 10 M)

4.1 What a Buyer Persona Is

DEFINITION • Buyer Persona

A ***buyer persona*** is a semi-fictional, research-based profile of the ideal customer — given a name, a face, a backstory and a set of goals, pain points and behaviours — built from real data about existing customers rather than from assumption.

The governing rule is that you cannot hit a target you have not defined. The working ideal is four to six distinct personas per business — for a B2B purchase, for example, an Executive Sponsor, a Decision Maker and an End User, who have different goals and raise different objections about the same product.

SEMI-FICTIONAL, NOT FICTIONAL

The word "semi-fictional" does real work. The *name and the photograph* are invented so the profile is memorable and shareable. The *goals, pain points, objections and behaviours* are not invented — they come from surveys, analytics, CRM records and review mining. A persona built entirely from imagination is a stereotype, and it will mislead every decision downstream.

4.2 The Five-Step Process

THE OFFICIAL FIVE STEPS

1. Research your current customers → 2. Segment your audience → 3. Gather data → 4. Identify goals and pain points → 5. Build the persona — then validate and update it continuously.

1. **Research your current customers.** Analyse the best existing clients — those who buy often, leave reviews and engage with content. Conduct surveys or interviews, online or through post-purchase feedback forms.
2. **Segment your audience.** Divide customers into categories based on shared traits. For a travel agency: by travel habits, destination preferences and trip budgets.
3. **Gather data.** Use tools such as Google Analytics and social media insights to identify patterns in who actually interacts with the website and the social pages — as distinct from who management imagines does.
4. **Identify goals and pain points.** For an adventure-tourism customer, the desire for adventure set directly against safety concerns. Personas are most useful where the goal and the pain point are in tension, because that tension is what the marketing has to resolve.
5. **Build the persona.** Give it a name, a photograph and a backstory to make it relatable — "Adventurous Ananya", "Explorer Ethan" — and attach the key data points. Then validate and update it using continuing customer feedback and trend data.

4.3 Factors to Capture

Table 4.1. Persona factors, with an adventure-tourism illustration

Category	Factors to capture	Adventure-tourism illustration
Demographics	Age, gender, income level, occupation, education, location, family status	20–40 years; working professionals and students; income sufficient to afford travel; metro-based
Psychographics	Values, attitudes, hobbies, aspirations, risk appetite	Interest in trekking, scuba diving, skydiving; fitness and outdoor lifestyle; risk-taking attitude; prefers unique experiences over luxury
Online behaviour	Platforms used, search patterns, content preference, device, booking behaviour	Instagram, YouTube and travel blogs; searches "best trekking places"; prefers videos, reels and reviews; books online packages via mobile apps
Category behaviour	Frequency, budget tier, group against solo, preferred variants	Travels two or three times a year; budget against premium; solo or small group; mountains, beaches, forests
Goals	What success looks like for them	Unique, thrilling, shareable experiences
Pain points	What blocks the purchase	Safety concerns, budget constraints, lack of reliable information, distrust of agencies

Category	Factors to capture	Adventure-tourism illustration
Objections	What they say when they say no	"Is it safe?" "Is the guide certified?" "What if I have to cancel?"

4.4 The Persona Builder Canvas

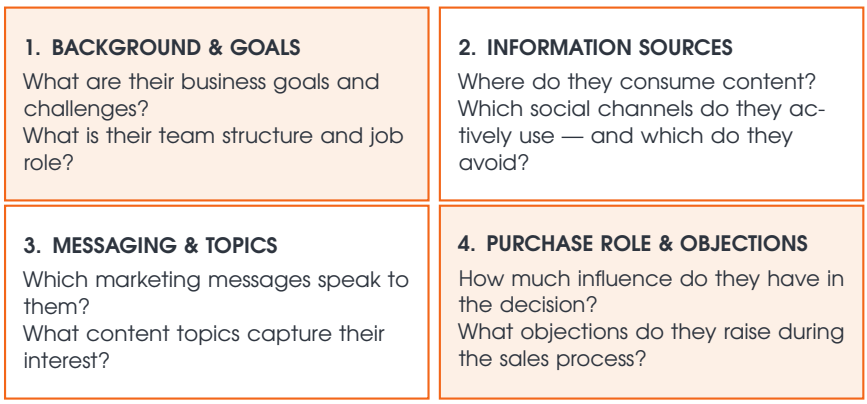


Figure 4.1. The persona builder canvas. Quadrants 1 and 3 establish who they are and what moves them; quadrants 2 and 4 establish where to reach them and what will stop the sale.

4.5 A Worked Persona

PERSONA: "ADVENTURE ARUN"

Name	Adventure Arun
Age	28
Occupation	IT professional, Bengaluru
Interests	Trekking, camping, weekend rides
Behaviour	Follows travel influencers on Instagram and YouTube; researches on travel blogs; books entirely online, usually on mobile, usually three to four weeks ahead
Goal	Unique, thrilling experiences he can share
Pain points	Safety and affordability; not knowing whether the operator is credible
What wins him	Certified-guide credentials, real customer video testimonials, transparent inclusions, easy cancellation, instalment options

Note what the last row does. "What wins him" converts the persona from a description into an instruction: each item is a specific asset the marketing team must now produce. A persona that does not end in such a list has not finished its job.

4.6 The Toolset

Table 4.2. Tools for building a buyer persona

Category	Tools	What they give you
Analytics	Google Analytics 4, Google Search Console	Demographics, interests, devices, locations, acquisition channels, on-site behaviour
Social insights	Meta Audience Insights, Instagram Insights, LinkedIn Page Analytics, X Analytics, YouTube Studio	Follower demographics, active hours, content resonance
Survey and voice of customer	Google Forms, Typeform, SurveyMonkey, Hotjar polls, post-purchase feedback forms	Stated goals, objections and satisfaction
Persona builders	HubSpot Make My Persona, Xtensio, Userforge, Semrush Persona	A structured template and a shareable persona document
Behavioural and qualitative mining	Quora, Reddit, Amazon reviews, YouTube comments, competitor review sections	The exact behavioural problems and questions the audience is trying to solve, in their own words
CRM and sales data	HubSpot, Zoho, Salesforce, sales-call notes	Real objections, deal-cycle length, decision roles

HARD DATA TELLS YOU WHO; SOCIAL LISTENING TELLS YOU WHY

Use Google Analytics and Meta Audience Insights for hard data on age, location and income. Use Quora, Reddit and Amazon reviews to extract the behavioural material — pain points, common questions, motivations, desired outcomes, objections and influences — that the audience is actively trying to resolve. Neither source substitutes for the other: analytics cannot tell you a motive, and a forum thread cannot tell you a market size.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

A buyer persona is a semi-fictional, research-based profile of the ideal customer; four to six per business is the working ideal. Build it in five steps — research current customers, segment, gather data, identify goals and pain points, then construct and continuously validate. Capture seven categories of factor: demographics, psychographics, online behaviour, category behaviour, goals, pain points and objections. The canvas organises the questions into background and goals, information sources, messaging and topics, and purchase role and objections. Analytics and social insights supply who; surveys, review mining and CRM records supply why. A finished persona ends in a list of assets the team must produce.

CHAPTER 5

Competitor Research Tools

SYLLABUS EXTRACT

Competitor Research Tools.

WHAT THIS CHAPTER COVERS

- The seven things to look for in a competitor analysis.
- The toolset, and what each tool is specifically good at.
- Why the content gap is the most valuable output of the exercise.

"Know the competition" is the second pillar of digital strategy (§ 2.1). Competition online can come from around the corner or around the globe, so the analysis must never be limited to local rivals.

5.1 What to Look For

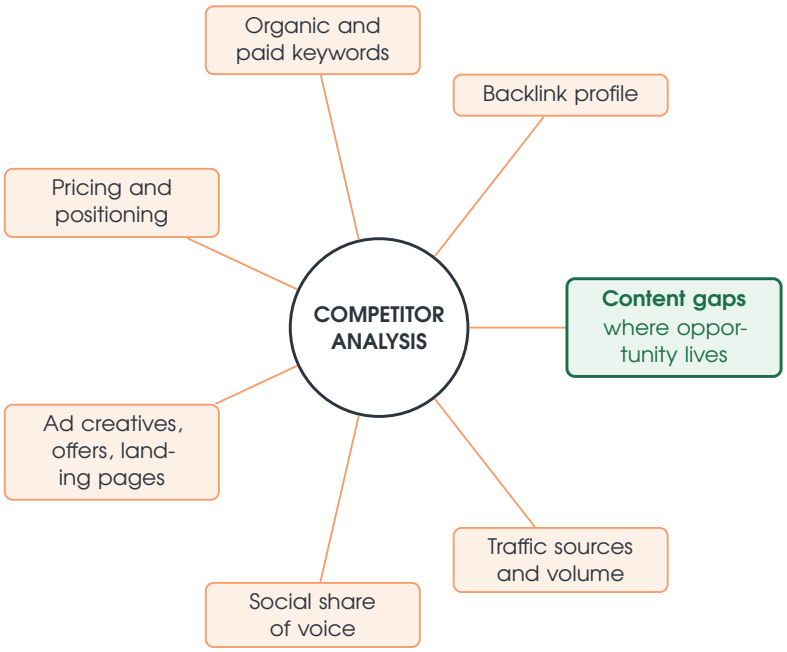


Figure 5.1. The seven dimensions of competitor analysis. Six describe what rivals are doing; the seventh — the content gap — describes what none of them is doing, and that is where the opportunity is.

- Which keywords they rank for organically, and which they pay for.
- Their **backlink profile** — who links to them, and why.

- Their **content gaps** — topics with demonstrated demand that nobody has covered well. This is where opportunity lives.
- Their traffic sources and volume, and how these are trending.
- Their **social share of voice** — conversations about them against conversations about you.
- Their advertising creatives, offers and landing pages.
- Their pricing, positioning and value proposition.

5.2 The Toolset

Table 5.1. Competitor research tools

Tool	Primary use
SEMrush	All-round competitive intelligence — organic and paid keywords, traffic estimates, advertising copy, backlink gap, Keyword Magic Tool
Ahrefs	Backlink analysis on the deepest link index; Content Gap and Top Pages reports
Moz / Link Explorer	Domain Authority and Page Authority scoring, link metrics
SimilarWeb	Traffic estimates, traffic sources, audience overlap, referral analysis
SpyFu	Historical competitor PPC keyword and advertising-spend data
BuzzSumo	Which content in a topic earned the most shares and backlinks — content-gap discovery
Google Trends	Relative search interest over time, seasonality, regional variation, rising queries
Google Keyword Planner	Search volume and competition data straight from the advertising platform
Meta Ad Library, Google Ads Transparency Center	The competitor's live advertising creatives, free of charge
Social listening — Hootsuite, Brandwatch, Mention, Sprout Social	Share of voice, sentiment, brand mention tracking

5.3 Turning Findings into Decisions

A competitor report that ends in observations has failed. Each finding should resolve into one of three decisions.

- **Emulate** — they are doing something that works, and it is transferable. Copy the mechanism, not the creative.
- **Avoid** — they are doing something that visibly is not working. Their sunk cost is your free experiment.
- **Occupy** — nobody is doing it, and there is demand. This is the content gap, and it is the only one of the three that produces a durable advantage, because the other two put you where competitors already are.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Competitor analysis examines organic and paid keywords, backlinks, content gaps, traffic sources and trends, social share of voice, advertising creatives and landing pages, and pricing and positioning. SEMrush and Ahrefs carry the keyword and backlink work, SimilarWeb the traffic estimates, SpyFu the historical advertising data, BuzzSumo the content performance, Google Trends the seasonality, and the ad transparency libraries the live creatives at no cost. Every finding must resolve into emulate, avoid or occupy — and only occupying a genuine content gap produces durable advantage.

CHAPTER 6

Website Analysis Tools

SYLLABUS EXTRACT

Website Analysis Tools.

WHAT THIS CHAPTER COVERS

- The two halves of website analysis: technical health and behavioural insight.
- The toolset by category, and what each tool actually measures.
- The six mechanisms by which website analysis improves customer experience and conversion.

HIGH YIELD

This chapter answers a compulsory Question 2 sub-division in the Semester End Examination. (SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q2a — 8 M)

6.1 The Two Halves

Website analysis has two halves, and a complete answer names both. **Technical health** asks whether the site works — whether it loads fast, whether it can be crawled and indexed, whether links resolve. **Behavioural insight** asks what people do once it works — where they hesitate, where they scroll, where they abandon.

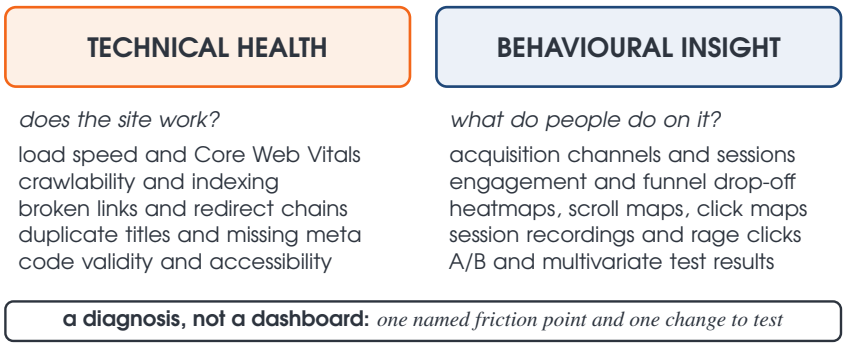


Figure 6.1. Technical health and behavioural insight answer different questions. Reporting either alone produces numbers without a decision.

6.2 The Toolset

Table 6.1. Website analysis tools

Tool	What it analyses
Google Analytics 4	Sessions, users, acquisition channels, engagement, conversions, funnels, audience demographics
Google Search Console	Impressions, clicks, average position, indexing status, Core Web Vitals, crawl errors
Google PageSpeed Insights / Lighthouse	Load speed, Core Web Vitals (LCP, INP, CLS), accessibility, SEO and best-practice audits
GTmetrix / Pingdom	Page load waterfall, asset weight, server response time
Hotjar / Microsoft Clarity / Crazy Egg	Heatmaps, scroll maps, click maps and session recordings — what users actually do
Screaming Frog SEO Spider	Full technical crawl — broken links, duplicate titles, redirect chains, missing meta
SEMrush Site Audit / Ahrefs Site Audit	Automated technical SEO health score and prioritised issue list
VWO / Optimizely	A/B testing and multivariate testing of pages and elements
Google Tag Manager	Central deployment and management of all tracking tags without touching code
W3C Validator / WAVE	Code validity and accessibility conformance

6.3 How Website Analysis Improves Experience and Conversion

MODEL ANSWER — 8 MARKS

(SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q2a — 8 M) Name the tools by category, then give the six mechanisms. The mechanisms, not the tool names, are what earn the marks.

1. **Diagnoses friction.** Heatmaps and session recordings expose where users hesitate, rage-click or abandon — behaviour no aggregate metric would reveal.
2. **Fixes speed.** Slow pages are the single largest cause of abandonment, so speed audits convert directly into retained sessions.
3. **Reveals the drop-off point in the funnel.** Funnel reports show which step loses people, so the fix is targeted rather than cosmetic.
4. **Validates changes objectively** through A/B testing instead of opinion or seniority.
5. **Segments experience by device and channel**, exposing faults that averages hide — a mobile-only checkout bug, for instance, is invisible in a blended conversion rate.
6. **Aligns content with intent** by showing which pages attract traffic that never converts — the classic "traffic without intent" problem.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Website analysis splits into technical health — speed, Core Web Vitals, crawlability, broken links, code validity — and behavioural insight — acquisition, engagement, funnels, heatmaps, recordings and split tests. Google Analytics 4 and Search Console are the base layer; PageSpeed Insights and GTmetrix cover performance; Hotjar and Clarity cover behaviour; Screaming Frog and the site-audit tools cover crawl health; VWO and Optimizely run the experiments; Tag Manager deploys the tracking. Analysis improves conversion by diagnosing friction, fixing speed, locating funnel drop-off, validating changes by test, segmenting by device and channel, and aligning content with intent.

CHAPTER 7

Content Marketing — Concepts and Strategies

SYLLABUS EXTRACT

Content Marketing: Content Marketing Concepts & Strategies.

WHAT THIS CHAPTER COVERS

- What content marketing is, and the one rule that governs it.
- A century of evidence that the strategy predates the internet.
- The compounding traffic curve, and why it beats the advertising sawtooth.
- The five traits that distinguish elite content marketers.
- The seven-point quality gate for content — and the second accepted list.

7.1 Definition and the Core Idea

DEFINITION • Content Marketing

Content marketing is a strategic marketing approach focused on creating and distributing valuable, relevant and consistent content to attract and retain a clearly defined audience — and, ultimately, to drive profitable customer action.

Four words in that definition are load-bearing. *Valuable* means the audience would want it even if the brand were removed from it. *Relevant* means it connects to what they are doing now. *Consistent* means published to a rhythm, because a single asset does not compound. And *profitable customer action* means the objective is commercial — content marketing is not publishing for its own sake.

THE GOVERNING PRINCIPLE

Don't sell the product; solve the problem. Great content integrates the product into the customer's natural pursuit of their own interests, rather than interrupting that pursuit to talk about the product.

7.2 A Century of Proof

Content marketing is routinely presented as a consequence of the internet. It is not. The three canonical examples all predate it by decades.

Table 7.1. Content marketing before the internet

Year	Example	Strategy
1895	John Deere's *The Furrow*	Educate the farmer — a magazine about farming, not about tractors
1900	The Michelin Guide	Inspire the driver to travel farther for a three-star meal, creating the need for more tyres
1930s	Soap operas	Entertain the homemaker with radio dramas sponsored by soap companies

THE SYNTHESIS

The medium changes. The strategy does not. Michelin did not advertise tyres; it made driving farther desirable. John Deere did not advertise ploughs; it made farmers better at farming. That is still exactly what content marketing does.

7.3 The Compounding Traffic Curve

Paid advertising produces a sawtooth: spend, spike, stop, collapse. Content produces a curve that starts slower and then rises continuously, because each asset keeps earning traffic long after it is published, and new assets stack on top of old ones.

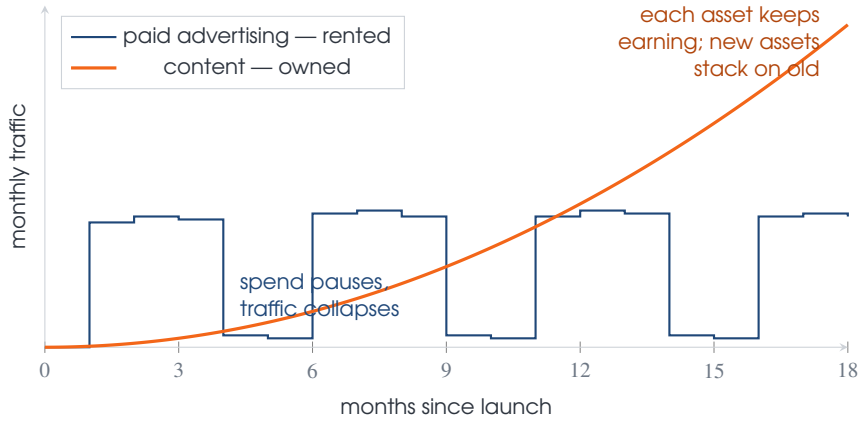


Figure 7.1. Paid advertising buys a plateau that ends with the budget. Content buys a curve. Content is slower to the first result and the only one of the two that accumulates.

THE APPLE TREE RULE

It takes time to plant the seed and grow the tree. But once mature, that single tree continually bears fruit for years, without requiring anyone to buy the apples. Advertising is a rented treadmill; content is an owned asset.

7.4 The Five Traits of Elite Content Marketers

1. **Documented strategy** — they operate from a written plan, not from intuition.
2. **Dedicated leadership** — a specific named person is accountable for the content engine.
3. **Expanded tactics** — they use a wider variety of content formats than their peers.
4. **Multi-platform distribution** — they leverage more channels than their peers.

5. **Budget allocation** — they commit a higher percentage of the total marketing budget to content.

7.5 Characteristics of Good Content — The Seven-Point Quality Gate

GUARANTEED SHORT QUESTION

Two slightly different lists are accepted; learn the first and know the second. (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026; SEE, Jun/Jul 2025 — 2 M each)

Table 7.2. The seven-point content quality gate

Trait	The diagnostic question
Credible	Will they believe it?
Shareable	Will the audience want to share it?
Useful or fun	Does it provide genuine utility or entertainment?
Interesting	Does it break through apathy? — necessarily subjective
Relevant	Does it connect to their current context?
Different	Does it stand out from the noise?
On-brand	Is it authentically aligned with our identity?

THE SECOND ACCEPTED LIST

The 2026 scheme of valuation accepted any four of: **relevant, accurate, engaging, clear, consistent, valuable**. If the question says "mention any four", either list scores full marks — but the seven-point gate above is the one taught in the lecture notes, and it is the safer answer because each trait carries a diagnostic question you can expand if asked to explain.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Content marketing creates and distributes valuable, relevant, consistent content to attract and retain a defined audience and drive profitable action; the rule is solve the problem, don't sell the product. The strategy predates the internet — John Deere in 1895, Michelin in 1900, sponsored radio drama in the 1930s. Advertising produces a sawtooth that collapses when spending stops; content produces a compounding curve, which is the apple tree rule. Elite practitioners share five traits: a documented strategy, dedicated leadership, expanded tactics, multi-platform distribution and higher budget share. Good content is credible, shareable, useful or fun, interesting, relevant, different and on-brand.

CHAPTER 8

Planning, Creating, Distributing and Promoting Content

SYLLABUS EXTRACT

Planning, Creating, Distributing & Promoting Content.

WHAT THIS CHAPTER COVERS

- The eight-step content marketing process, in three phases.
- Each step in detail: goals, audience mapping, ideation, creation, distribution, amplification, evaluation, improvement.
- How to map content to funnel stage and to the 5A customer path.
- The complete content flywheel.

THE FRAMEWORK THAT ANSWERS EVERY SCENARIO QUESTION

Every "design a content marketing strategy for company X" question in this course is answered by walking through these eight steps in order. Memorise the step names. (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025 — 10 M; CIE-I, 1 Jul 2024 — 10 M; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 10 M)

8.1 The Eight Steps in Three Phases

THE OFFICIAL SCHEME ANSWER

1. Goal Setting → 2. Audience Mapping → 3. Content Ideation and Planning → 4. Content Creation → 5. Content Distribution → 6. Content Amplification → 7. Content Marketing Evaluation → 8. Content Marketing Improvement — and then back to step 1.

It is a cycle, not a checklist.

Table 8.1. The three phases

Phase	Steps	Purpose
Phase 1 — Architecture	Goal setting, audience mapping, ideation and planning	Decide why, for whom, and what
Phase 2 — Mechanics	Creation, distribution, amplification	Actually build it, and get it in front of people

Phase	Steps	Purpose
Phase 3 — Telemetry	Evaluation, improvement	Find out whether it worked, and make the next cycle better

8.2 Step 1 — Goal Setting

The primary objective always splits into two branches, and every subsequent decision inherits from this split.

- **Brand-building objective** — awareness, recall, reputation, authority, share of voice.
- **Sales-growth objective** — leads, conversions, revenue, repeat purchase.

Three reflective questions found the goal: what content will be valuable to the company; how can the content tell a story about the brand; and how will the content marketing strategy actually be executed.

> **THE FIRST STEP IS NOT "CREATE CONTENT"**
>
> Asked "what is the first step of content marketing?", the official answer is **define goals and identify the target audience**. Answering "create content" scores nothing. (CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 2 M)

8.3 Step 2 — Audience Mapping

Audience mapping is built outward from internal psychology, not inward from demographics, and the order matters.

8.4 Step 3 — Content Ideation and Planning

Ideation must be constrained by a disciplined roadmap, or it degenerates into random posting. Four layers produce the plan.

Table 8.2. The four layers of the content plan

Layer	Output
Strategic layer	The content theme — the territory the brand will own
Structural layer	The content formats and mix — which media, in what ratio
Temporal layer	The storyline and calendar — what publishes when, and in what narrative order
Result	**The content road map**

8.5 Step 4 — Content Creation

The pivot question is who creates the content, and when. Two resource branches feed a single production schedule: in-house creators and external agencies. In-house wins on brand authenticity and subject knowledge; agencies win on capacity, production quality and speed.

8.5.1 Aligning format to funnel stage

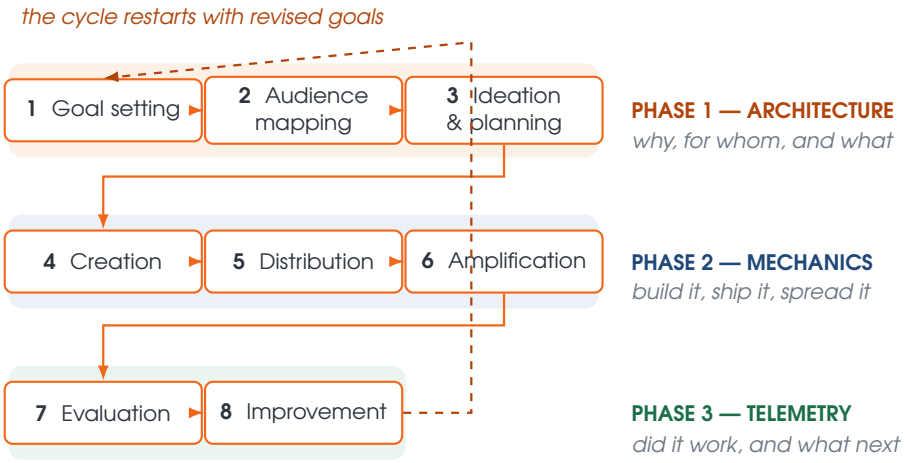


Figure 8.1. The eight steps in three phases. Steps 7 and 8 are not a report at the end — they are the input to the next cycle's step 1.

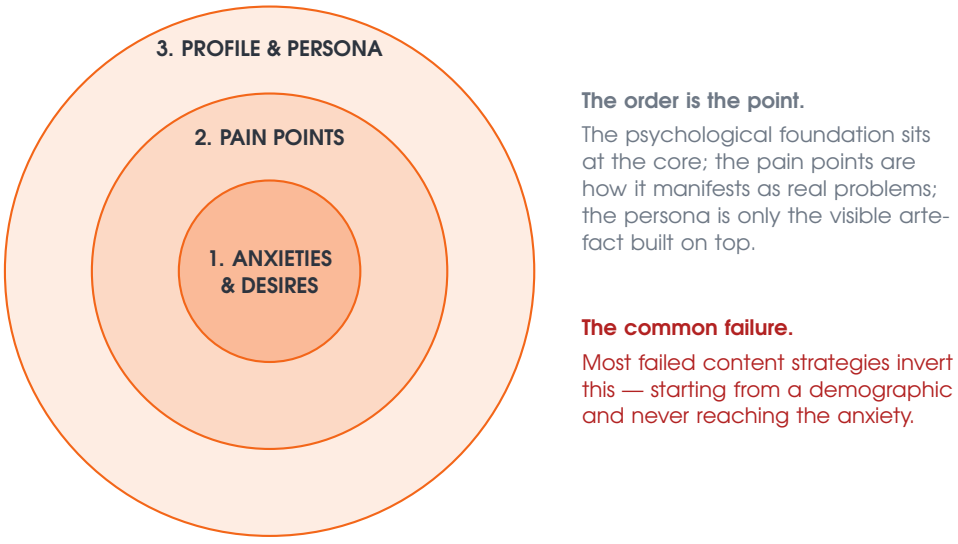


Figure 8.2. Audience mapping works from the inside out. Chapter 4 gives the full persona method that produces the outermost layer.

Table 8.3. Content format by funnel stage

Stage	Formats	KPI
Awareness	Infographics, social videos, podcasts	Reach and shares
Engagement	How-to blogs, video tutorials	Dwell time and video views
Evaluation	Case studies, e-books, whitepapers	Leads and downloads
Purchase and retention	Newsletters, native advertising, product updates	Conversion and open rates

8.5.2 Anatomy of a top-ranking page

- **H1 title** — click-worthy, with the exact-match keyword.
- **Introduction** — comprehensive, answering the user's core intent immediately rather than after four paragraphs of preamble.
- **Structure** — H2 and H3 subheadings containing long-tail keyword variants.
- **Formatting** — short, scannable paragraphs and bulleted lists.
- **Rich media** — embedded videos and infographics, to increase dwell time.
- **Architecture** — internal links to keep users in your ecosystem, plus credible outbound links to build trust.

8.6 Step 5 — Content Distribution

Distribution runs on the owned, paid and earned trinity of § 3.2. Choose the mix using the distribution matrix below, which trades predictability against lifespan.

Table 8.4. The distribution ecosystem matrix

Channel	Predictability	Lifespan	Core characteristics
Google SEO	High	Infinite	High buyer intent, search-driven
YouTube	Medium	Long	Dual search-and-social algorithm; massive visual trust
Social media	Low	Short — hours	Flatlining traffic curve; relies on viral spikes
E-mail	High	Medium	Direct ownership; highest conversion and retention

8.7 Step 6 — Content Amplification

Amplification creates compounding momentum by activating network effects. The central question is how to leverage content assets and interact with customers. Three nodes answer it.

1. **Creating communities** — owned groups, forums and user communities that redistribute content for you.
2. **Use of buzzers** — employees, partners and enthusiasts who seed and share content early, before any algorithm has decided whether it deserves reach.
3. **Use of influencers** — borrowing the trust of established opinion leaders (§ 1.9.5).



Figure 8.3. The 5A path. Each stage imposes a different requirement on the content, and content that satisfies one stage will not satisfy the next.

8.8 Mapping Content to the 5A Customer Path

A CONTENT-DRIVEN CUSTOMER JOURNEY

	What the customer thinks	What they consume
Problem aware	"The kids need something to climb on."	Searches "best home climbing equipment"
Solution research	"Mini jungle gyms exist."	Reads a "top ten jungle gyms" blog post
Product evaluation	"Will my oldest fit?"	Watches a video product review
Purchase	"This model works."	Reads marketplace reviews and buys

The architect's note: the brand must be intentionally present at every stepping stone. If your content is not there, a competitor's is.

8.9 Steps 7 and 8 — Evaluation and Improvement

The evaluation question is how successful the content marketing campaign was, and it is answered through two measurement protocols: tracking specific content-marketing metrics — KPIs such as traffic, engagement rate, lead generation and conversion tied to individual assets — and determining overall objective achievement, the holistic impact on brand awareness, reputation and revenue, which loops back to the brand-building and sales-growth goals set in step 1.

Improvement then pulls on exactly two levers.

- **Lever 1 — content theme change and improvement**, which adjusts the architecture of Phase 1.
- **Lever 2 — distribution and amplification improvement**, which adjusts the mechanics of Phase 2.

Two practices keep the loop running: **A/B testing**, continuously split-testing headline variants, call-to-action tone, image choices and content length; and **historical audits**, regularly updating older high-ranking content with fresh data, new internal links and current examples, to protect traffic that already exists.

WORKED SCENARIO — "ECOCHEF" ECO-FRIENDLY KITCHEN APPLIANCES

(CIE-I, 1 Jul 2024 — 10 M) Apply the eight-step framework explicitly.

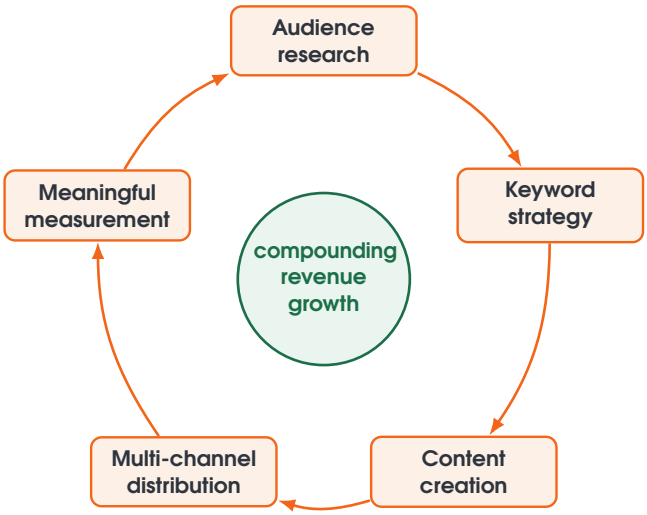


Figure 8.4. The content flywheel. Each phase powers the next, and measurement optimises the following cycle rather than merely reporting on the last one. Content is never finished; it is an asset requiring continuous maintenance.

- **Goals.** Build awareness of EcoChef among urban eco-conscious households; generate 5,000 e-mail subscribers in six months; achieve a 3% landing-page conversion rate.
- **Personas.** Sustainability-minded young families; first-home buyers.
- **Themes.** Sustainable cooking, energy savings, kitchen-to-table living, product demonstrations.
- **Content types.** SEO blogs ("how much energy does an induction hob save"), recipe videos and reels, comparison infographics, a downloadable energy-savings calculator, webinars with chefs, customer-generated content.
- **Distribution.** Owned — website, blog, e-mail. Paid — Google Ads on high-intent appliance keywords, Instagram and video advertising. Earned — sustainability influencers, press, product reviews.
- **Engagement.** A community group, a recipe contest, responsive social customer care, a nurture e-mail sequence.
- **Measurement.** Reach, engagement rate, leads, conversions and content-attributed revenue — feeding back into theme and distribution improvement.

WORKED SCENARIO — ORGANIC HEALTH AND WELLNESS STARTUP

(CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 10 M) The official scheme structures the answer in five headed parts.

1. **Objectives** — build brand awareness; educate customers on organic lifestyle; generate leads and conversions.
2. **Content themes** — organic living and its benefits; health and nutrition; sustainability and eco-friendly practices; product awareness; customer testimonials and expert advice.
3. **Content formats** — blogs and articles for SEO; videos and reels (workouts, product demonstrations); infographics (diet charts); podcasts (wellness talks); e-books and webinars; user-generated content and reviews.
4. **Distribution platforms** — *owned*: website, blog, e-mail; *earned*: social shares, influencer mentions, public relations; *paid*: social advertising, Google Ads, influencer promotions.
5. **Metrics** — awareness: reach, impressions, website traffic; engagement: likes, shares, comments, watch time; leads: sign-ups, downloads; conversions: sales and conversion rate; retention: repeat customers and loyalty.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Content marketing runs as an eight-step cycle in three phases: architecture (goals, audience mapping, ideation), mechanics (creation, distribution, amplification) and telemetry (evaluation, improvement). Goals split into brand-building and sales-growth, and everything downstream inherits from that split. Audience mapping works inward-out from anxieties to pain points to persona. The plan has strategic, structural and temporal layers producing a road map. Format follows funnel stage. Distribution trades predictability against lifespan across SEO, video, social and e-mail. Amplification uses communities, buzzers and influencers. The 5A path demands content that is visible, relatable, searchable, actionable and shareable in turn. Evaluation feeds two improvement levers — theme and distribution — and the flywheel restarts.

CHAPTER 9

Optimizing Website UX and Landing Pages

SYLLABUS EXTRACT

Optimize Website UX & Landing Pages.

WHAT THIS CHAPTER COVERS

- Krug's first law of usability.
- The seven usability attributes and their test questions.
- How people actually use the web — scanning, satisficing, muddling through.
- Billboard design: designing for scanning rather than reading.
- The eight essentials of a converting landing page.

Traffic that arrives at a badly designed page is wasted money. This material is shared ground with Unit IV (web design) and Unit V (conversion optimization); what follows is the content-marketing view of it.

9.1 Krug's First Law of Usability

DON'T MAKE ME THINK

A person of average — or below average — ability must be able to work out how to accomplish a task on the page. It must be self-evident and self-explanatory. The good news is that usability is not rocket science.

9.2 The Seven Usability Attributes

Table 9.1. The seven usability attributes

Attribute	Test question
Useful	Does it do what people actually need?
Learnable	Can they figure it out?
Memorable	Do they have to relearn it every visit?
Effective	Does it get the job done?
Efficient	Does it do so in a reasonable amount of time?
Desirable	Do people want it?
Delightful	Is it enjoyable to use?

9.3 How People Actually Use the Web

There is a gap between how designers imagine people use websites — carefully reading instructions like a novel — and how they actually do: ***scanning***, ***satisficing*** and muddling through. Satisficing means choosing the first option that plausibly works rather than the best one available.

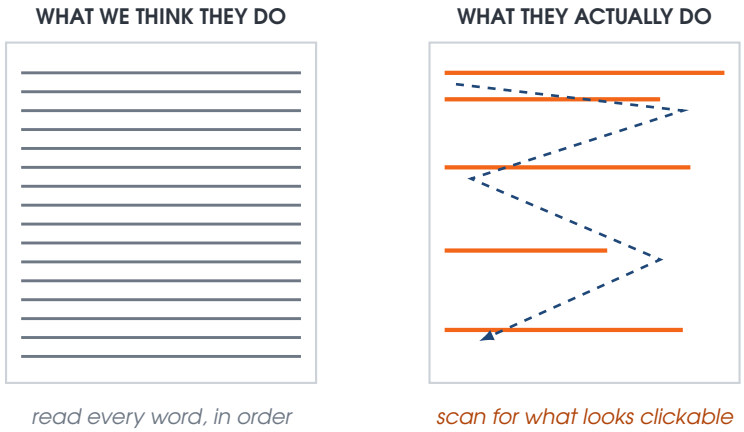


Figure 9.1. Users do not read pages; they scan them for the first thing that looks like it will get the job done. Pages must be designed for the right-hand behaviour.

Why don't people read instructions? Three reasons.

1. It isn't important to them — they just want it to work.
2. They are on a mission, and know they don't need to read everything.
3. If they find something that works, they stick to it rather than looking for a better way.

9.4 Billboard Design — Design for Scanning, Not Reading

- **Follow visual hierarchy** — make important elements visually prominent, in proportion to their importance.
- **Omit needless words** — the art of not writing for the web. Happy talk must die; unnecessary instructions must die.
- **Make clickables obvious** — it must be instantly clear what can be clicked. Competition is one click away, and ambiguity produces frustration.
- **Provide breadcrumbs and street signs** — clear, conventional, intuitive navigation, so the user always knows where they are.

9.5 Landing Page Essentials

- **One page, one job.** A landing page with two goals achieves neither.
- **A headline that matches the advertisement** that brought the visitor there. *Message match* is the largest single lever on conversion rate.
- **A clear, prominent, single call to action**, repeated above and below the fold.
- **Benefit-led copy, not feature-led** — what the visitor gets, not what the product has.
- **Trust signals** — testimonials, ratings, certifications, guarantees, secure-payment badges, real photographs.
- **Minimal form friction** — every additional field reduces completion. Ask only for what will actually be used.

- **Fast load and mobile responsiveness** — non-negotiable.
- **Remove navigation and exits** on a dedicated campaign landing page, so the only way forward is the call to action.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Krug's first law is don't make me think: a page must be self-evident. Usability is tested against seven attributes — useful, learnable, memorable, effective, efficient, desirable, delightful. People scan rather than read, satisfice rather than optimise, and muddle through rather than learn, so pages must be designed as billboards: visual hierarchy, no needless words, obvious clickables and conventional navigation. A converting landing page has one job, a headline that matches its advertisement, a single repeated call to action, benefit-led copy, trust signals, minimal form friction, fast mobile load, and no exits.

CHAPTER 10

Measuring Impact — Metrics and Performance

SYLLABUS EXTRACT

Measure Impact; Metrics & Performance.

WHAT THIS CHAPTER COVERS

- The three diagnostic buckets that give a metrics answer its structure.
- The five metrics to name, and how each changes the next content cycle.
- The rule that the metric must match the medium.
- The five-step method for aligning KPIs to organisational goals.

STRUCTURE EARNS THE MARKS

A list of metrics without a structure scores poorly. Organise any metrics answer into the three buckets below, and for each metric state explicitly *how the reading changes the next decision*. (CIE-I, 1 Jul 2024 — 10 M; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 10 M)

10.1 The Three Diagnostic Buckets

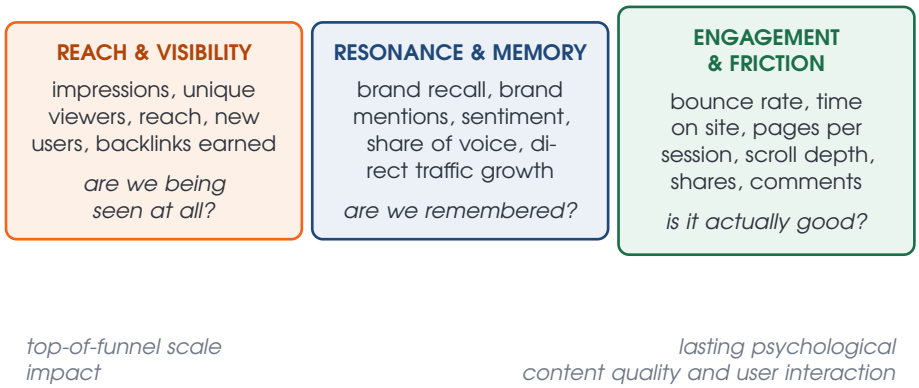


Figure 10.1. Each bucket diagnoses a different failure. High reach with low resonance is a memorability problem; high resonance with high friction is an execution problem.

10.2 The Five Metrics to Name

1. **Website traffic and unique visitors** — measures whether content is attracting an audience. *Influence on strategy:* rising traffic on a theme signals which topics to double down on.

2. **Engagement rate** — time on page, scroll depth, pages per session, likes, shares, comments; measures whether the content held attention. *Influence:* a high-traffic, low-engagement page signals a headline that over-promises.
3. **Bounce rate** — the percentage of visitors who leave after viewing only one page without interaction. *Influence:* a high bounce on a converting keyword points to a message-match or a speed problem.
4. **Lead generation** — form submissions, sign-ups, downloads; measures whether content converts attention into a contactable relationship. *Influence:* identifies which assets deserve gated versions and paid promotion.
5. **Conversion rate and ROI** — the percentage completing the desired action, and revenue attributable to content against its cost. *Influence:* determines budget allocation for the next cycle.

Further metrics worth naming if the question asks for more: organic search ranking, keyword coverage, backlinks earned, e-mail open and click-through rates, customer retention and repeat purchase rate, and cost per lead.

10.3 Align the Metric to the Medium

THE MEASUREMENT RULE

Align the metric to the medium. Measuring an e-book by pageviews is a recipe for failure.

Video → audience retention and total watch time. Blog and SEO → organic rank and dwell time. Lead magnets → download volume and lead conversion rate. E-mail → open rate and click-through rate.

10.4 Aligning KPIs to Organisational Goals

MODEL ANSWER — 10 MARKS

(CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 10 M)

1. **Identify business goals** — define clear objectives: increase sales, brand awareness, lead generation.
2. **Map goals to relevant KPIs** — sales growth → conversion rate, revenue, cart-abandonment rate; brand awareness → traffic, impressions, reach; lead generation → form submissions, sign-ups; customer engagement → bounce rate, session duration, pages per visit.
3. **Make KPIs SMART** — Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound. For example: increase conversion rate by 10% in three months.
4. **Use analytics tools** — track through Google Analytics and dashboards.
5. **Monitor and optimise continuously** — analyse regularly and modify strategy on the basis of measured performance.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Structure every metrics answer into reach and visibility, resonance and memory, and engagement and friction. Name five metrics — traffic, engagement rate, bounce rate, lead generation, and conversion rate with ROI — and for each state how the reading changes the next cycle. Match the metric to the medium: watch time for video, rank and dwell for blogs, downloads for lead magnets, opens and clicks for e-mail. Align KPIs to goals in five steps: identify goals, map to KPIs, make them SMART,

instrument with analytics, and optimise continuously.

CHAPTER 11

Using Content Research for Opportunities

SYLLABUS EXTRACT

Using Content Research for Opportunities.

WHAT THIS CHAPTER COVERS

- The keyword sweet spot — volume, difficulty and commercial intent.
- The seven ways content research creates competitive edge.
- The content research toolset, by job.

HIGH YIELD

This chapter answers a compulsory Question 2 sub-division in the Semester End Examination. (SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q2b — 8 M)

11.1 Finding the Keyword Sweet Spot

A topic is worth pursuing only where three conditions overlap.

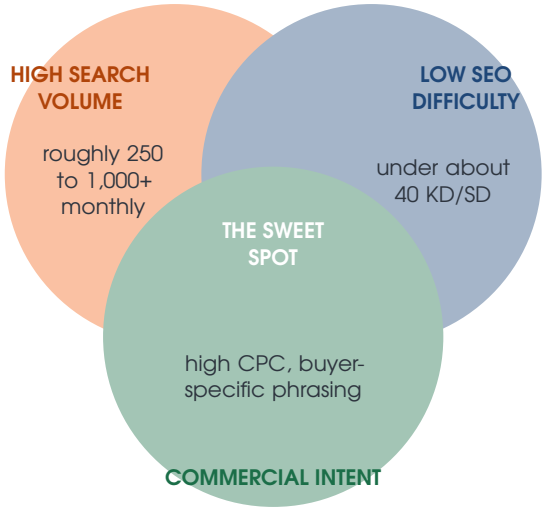


Figure 11.1. A topic is worth pursuing only in the central overlap. Two out of three is a trap: volume without intent is vanity, intent without achievability is wasted effort.

- **High search volume** — a minimum of roughly 250 to 1,000 or more monthly searches.
- **Low SEO difficulty** — under about a 40 difficulty score, so ranking is realistically achievable.

- **Commercial intent** — a high cost-per-click and buyer-specific phrasing, indicating the searcher intends to purchase.

TRAFFIC WITHOUT INTENT IS USELESS

Do not optimise for clicks; optimise for revenue. A page ranking first for a query no buyer ever types is a vanity asset.

11.2 How Content Research Creates Competitive Edge

MODEL ANSWER — 8 MARKS

(SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q2b — 8 M)

1. **Reveals demand that already exists.** Keyword and question research shows what the market is actively asking, removing guesswork.
2. **Exposes content gaps** — topics with volume where competitors rank poorly or not at all. This is the fastest route to visibility.
3. **Identifies trends early.** Google Trends and social listening surface rising topics before they saturate, allowing first-mover advantage.
4. **Benchmarks the competition.** It shows what already works in the niche, so effort goes to proven formats rather than experiments.
5. **Improves ROI.** Resources go to topics with demonstrated demand and achievable difficulty, instead of being spread evenly.
6. **Supplies the customer's own language.** Mining forums and reviews yields the exact phrasing to use in headlines and copy.
7. **Feeds every other channel.** One research pass supplies the SEO plan, the social calendar, the e-mail themes and the advertising copy.

11.3 The Content Research Toolset

Table 11.1. Content research tools by job

Job	Tools
Keyword research	Google Keyword Planner, SEMrush Keyword Magic Tool, Ahrefs Keywords Explorer, Ubersuggest
Question mining	AnswerThePublic, AlsoAsked, Google's "People Also Ask" and "Related searches"
Trend detection	Google Trends, Exploding Topics, platform trending topics
Content performance	BuzzSumo — most-shared and most-linked content in any topic; Ahrefs Content Explorer
Audience listening	Quora, Reddit, niche forums, marketplace and app-store reviews, video comments
Gap analysis	SEMrush Keyword Gap, Ahrefs Content Gap

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Pursue a topic only where high search volume, low SEO difficulty and commercial intent overlap; two out of three is a trap. Content research creates edge by revealing existing demand, exposing content gaps, catching trends early, benchmarking competitors, improving ROI, supplying the customer's own

language, and feeding every other channel from a single pass. The toolset divides by job: keyword research, question mining, trend detection, content performance, audience listening and gap analysis.

APPENDIX A

Syllabus-to-Chapter Concordance

This appendix exists so that coverage can be *audited* rather than assumed. The left-hand column reproduces the Unit I syllabus descriptor phrase by phrase, in the order the official document prints it. The right-hand column gives the chapter and section that carries it. Every phrase resolves to a location, and no numbered chapter of this volume contains material that is not traceable to a phrase in this table.

First half — Introduction to Digital Marketing

Table A.1. Concordance: Introduction to Digital Marketing

Syllabus phrase	Where it is covered
Introduction to Digital Marketing	Chapter 1 entire. Definition § 1.4; traditional against digital § 1.5; push and pull § 1.6; the marketing mix in the digital era § 1.7; enabling technology § 1.8; the digital consumer § 1.9. Marketing foundations § 1.1–1.3.
Principles of Digital Marketing	Chapter 2 entire. Five pillars § 2.1; the internet paradox § 2.2; the seven governing principles § 2.3; campaign characteristics § 2.4.
Digital Marketing Channels	Chapter 3 entire. Three senses of channel § 3.1; paid, owned and earned § 3.2; hub and spokes § 3.3; affiliate marketing § 3.4; channel choice § 3.5.
Tools to Create Buyer Persona	Chapter 4 entire. Definition § 4.1; five-step process § 4.2; factors § 4.3; canvas § 4.4; worked persona § 4.5; toolset § 4.6.
Competitor Research Tools	Chapter 5 entire. What to look for § 5.1; toolset § 5.2; converting findings into decisions § 5.3.
Website Analysis Tools	Chapter 6 entire. Technical health against behavioural insight § 6.1; toolset § 6.2; the six mechanisms § 6.3.

Second half — Content Marketing

Table A.2. Concordance: Content Marketing

Syllabus phrase	Where it is covered
Content Marketing Concepts & Strategies	Chapter 7 entire. Definition § 7.1; a century of proof § 7.2; the compounding curve § 7.3; elite traits § 7.4; the quality gate § 7.5.
Planning, Creating, Distributing & Promoting Content	Chapter 8 entire. The eight steps § 8.1; goal setting § 8.2; audience mapping § 8.3; ideation and planning § 8.4; creation § 8.5; distribution § 8.6; amplification § 8.7; the 5A path § 8.8; evaluation and improvement § 8.9.
Optimize Website UX & Landing Pages	Chapter 9 entire. Krug's first law § 9.1; usability attributes § 9.2; how people use the web § 9.3; billboard design § 9.4; landing page essentials § 9.5.
Measure Impact	Chapter 10, § 10.1 and § 10.3 — the diagnostic buckets and the rule that the metric must match the medium.
Metrics & Performance	Chapter 10, § 10.2 and § 10.4 — the five metrics and the alignment of KPIs to organisational goals.
Using Content Research for Opportunities	Chapter 11 entire. The keyword sweet spot § 11.1; the seven sources of edge § 11.2; the toolset § 11.3.

READING THE "ETC." IN THE SYLLABUS

The official descriptor ends several clauses with "etc.". That word is treated in this series as licence to complete a named framework, not as licence to add new topics. So where the syllabus says "Competitor Research Tools, Website Analysis Tools, etc.", the chapters cover those two tool families completely rather than introducing a third family the syllabus never names.

APPENDIX B

Previous-Year Question Bank — Unit I

Every question in this appendix is reproduced from an actual RVCE Marketing Management Continuous Internal Evaluation or Semester End Examination paper for this course. Answers and pointers follow the official schemes of valuation where those were released. The bracketed tag after each question records the paper, the date, and the mark allocation.

Part A — Two-Mark Questions

1. **Differentiate between marketplace and market space.** (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 2 M)
   Marketplace — a physical or digital location where buyers and sellers come together to exchange goods and services (a mall, a showroom). Market space — a conceptual or virtual environment where commercial value is created through digital networks and communication technologies (Amazon, an app). Shorthand: marketplace is physical, market space is digital. *See* § 1.2.2.

2. **What is the mantra of marketing?** (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025 — 2 M)
   Create, Communicate, Deliver, Value, Target, Profit. *See* § 1.1.2.

3. **Define affiliate marketing and give an example.** (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025 — 2 M)
   A performance-based marketing model in which a business rewards affiliates — partners or individuals — for driving traffic, leads or sales to its products or services through the affiliate's own marketing efforts. Example: Amazon Associates, where a blogger earns commission on purchases made via a tracked link. *See* § 3.4.

4. **Mention any four characteristics of a good content.** (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026; SEE, Jun/Jul 2025 — 2 M)
   Any four of: credible, shareable, useful, interesting, relevant, different, on-brand. The 2026 scheme also accepts relevant, accurate, engaging, clear, consistent, valuable. *See* § 7.5.

5. **Differentiate between push and pull marketing.** (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026; SEE, Jun/Jul 2025 — 2 M)
   Push — the brand promotes products by pushing them towards the customer (television advertising, dealer incentives, direct selling). Pull — the brand encourages customers to actively seek out the product (SEO, content, word of mouth). *See* § 1.6.

6. **What is the first step of content marketing?** (CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 2 M)
   Define goals and identify the target audience. *See* § 8.2.

7. **Mention any two core concepts of marketing.** (CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 2 M)
   Any two of: needs, wants, demand, value, exchange, markets. *See* § 1.1.6.

8. **List any two principles of digital marketing.** (SEE, Oct/Nov 2023 — 2 M)

Any two of the five pillars — know your business; know the competition; know your customers; know what you want to achieve; know how you're doing. Alternatively: measurability, interactivity, personalisation, permission-based targeting. *See* § 2.1 and § 2.3.

9. **Differentiate between market segmentation and market mix.** (SEE, Oct/Nov 2023 — 2 M)
Market segmentation is the process of dividing a heterogeneous total market into smaller homogeneous groups of buyers with similar needs, on bases such as geographic, demographic, psychographic and behavioural, so that each can be targeted distinctly. The marketing mix is the set of controllable tactical tools — Product, Price, Place and Promotion — that the firm blends to produce the response it wants from its chosen target segment. In short: segmentation decides *whom* to serve; the marketing mix decides *how* to serve them. *See* § 1.7 and Appendix C.3.

Part B — Eight- and Ten-Mark Questions

1. **A newly launched e-commerce company wants to build brand awareness through content marketing. Suggest a step-by-step strategy for them, including content types and distribution channels.** (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025 — 10 M)
Official scheme answer — the eight steps: goal setting, audience mapping, content ideation and planning, content creation, content distribution, content amplification, content marketing evaluation, content marketing improvement. Expand each with the detail in Chapter 8, naming content types (blogs, videos, infographics, podcasts, e-books, user-generated content) and distribution across owned, earned and paid media. *See* § 8.1 and § 3.2.

2. **A newly launched health & wellness startup offering organic lifestyle products aims to build strong brand awareness through content marketing. Design a step-by-step content marketing strategy, clearly outlining: content formats; content themes; distribution platforms (owned, earned, paid media); metrics for performance evaluation.** (CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 10 M)
The full five-part scheme answer is set out in Chapter 8 as a worked scenario. *See* § 8.9.

3. **A travel agency specializing in adventure tourism wants to improve its targeted marketing. How should they create a buyer persona, and what factors (e.g., demographics, interests, online behaviour) should they consider?** (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 10 M)
Answer in three parts. (i) *Steps:* collect data through surveys, website analytics and social media insights; segment the audience by shared traits; identify goals and pain points; build the persona profile with a name, background and behaviour details; validate and update using feedback and trends. (ii) *Factors:* demographics (age 20–40, gender, income, occupation, location); psychographics (trekking, scuba diving, skydiving, fitness and outdoor lifestyle, risk-taking attitude, preference for unique experiences over luxury); online behaviour (Instagram, YouTube, travel blogs; searches such as "best trekking places"; prefers videos and reviews; books online via mobile apps); travel behaviour (frequency, budget against premium, group against solo, preferred destinations); pain points (safety concerns, budget constraints, lack of information, trust in agencies). (iii) *Example persona:* Adventure Arun, 28, IT professional; interests trekking and camping; follows travel influencers and books online; goal is unique thrilling experiences; pain point is safety and affordability. *See* Chapter 4.

4. **A retail company has been using traditional marketing methods such as newspaper ads, billboards, and TV commercials. However, they are now considering a shift to digital marketing. Compare the benefits and limitations of both approaches and suggest a**

strategy for transitioning to digital marketing. (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 10 M)
Traditional benefits: wide reach through television and newspapers; high credibility and trust; effective for a mass audience. *Traditional limitations:* expensive; difficult to measure results; no precise targeting; one-way communication. *Digital benefits:* cost-effective; targeted by age, location and interest; measurable through analytics and ROI; two-way interaction; global reach. *Digital limitations:* requires technical skills; high online competition; privacy concerns; dependent on internet access. *Transition strategy:* the eight sequenced steps in § 1.5.3. *See* § 1.5.

5. **Identify and explain the various entities that can be marketed, providing relevant examples for each category.** (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025 — 10 M)
The ten entities — goods, services, experiences, events, persons, places, properties, organizations, information and ideas — each explained with an example. *See* § 1.1.5, Table 1.1.

6. **How have the 4Ps of marketing (Product, Price, Place, and Promotion) evolved in the digital era? Provide examples of companies effectively leveraging digital strategies for each element.** (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025 — 10 M)
Product → digital and personalised products (Spotify's data-driven playlists). Price → dynamic and transparent pricing (Amazon's AI-driven adjustment by demand, competition and user behaviour). Place → online channels and omnichannel presence (Nike's seamless website, app and store experience with click-and-collect). Promotion → digital and interactive marketing (Coca-Cola's "Share a Coke" campaign). *See* § 1.7.2, Table 1.5.

7. **Describe the key principles of digital marketing and explain how they differ from traditional marketing approaches. Provide examples to illustrate your points.** (CIE-I, 1 Jul 2024 — 10 M)
State the five pillars, add measurability, interactivity, personalisation, permission and iteration, then contrast each against traditional marketing using Table 1.3, with one concrete example per point. *See* Chapter 2 and § 1.5.2.

8. **Your company has a limited marketing budget and needs to choose between Search Engine Optimization, Pay Per Click, and Social Media Marketing to promote a new product. Based on the product being a high-tech gadget aimed at young professionals, which channel(s) would you prioritize and why? Justify your decision with specific examples.** (CIE-I, 1 Jul 2024 — 10 M)
Compare the three on speed, cost model, longevity, buyer intent and predictability, then commit to a weighted recommendation and justify it with the intent argument — a brand-new gadget generates no organic search demand yet, so paid and social must create the demand that SEO will later harvest. *See* § 3.5.

9. **Identify and explain at least five key metrics used to measure the impact and performance of content marketing efforts. How can these metrics influence future content strategies?** (CIE-I, 1 Jul 2024 — 10 M)
Name traffic, engagement rate, bounce rate, lead generation and conversion rate with ROI; group them into reach and visibility, resonance and memory, and engagement and friction; and for each state explicitly how the reading changes the next content cycle. *See* Chapter 10.

10. **Imagine you are a digital marketing strategist at GreenTech Innovations, a company launching a new line of eco-friendly kitchen appliances called "EcoChef." Design a comprehensive content marketing strategy to promote these products. Include specific**

goals, types of content, distribution channels, and methods of engagement with your target audience. (CIE-I, 1 Jul 2024 — 10 M)
The full worked answer is set out in Chapter 8. *See* § 8.9.

11. **What is Digital marketing? Explain the differences between Traditional Marketing and Digital Marketing. Highlight any 5 key differences.** (SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q2a — 8 M)
Define digital marketing, then give any five differences from Table 1.3 — communication direction, reach, cost, measurability and interactivity are the strongest five — each with a one-line example. *See* § 1.4 and § 1.5.2.

12. **List and explain various pricing strategies used in marketing management with suitable examples.** (SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q2b — 8 M)
Ten strategies with examples are set out in Appendix C.2, which also records why this topic sits outside the literal Unit I descriptor. *See* Appendix C.2.

13. **Explain how content research tools help marketers discover new opportunities and gain a competitive edge.** (SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q2b — 8 M)
The keyword sweet spot (volume × low difficulty × commercial intent), the seven ways research creates edge, and the toolset. *See* Chapter 11.

14. **Discuss how website analysis contributes to enhanced customer experience and conversion optimization.** (SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q2a — 8 M)
Name the tools by category, then give the six mechanisms: diagnosing friction, fixing speed, locating funnel drop-off, validating changes through A/B testing, segmenting by device and channel, and aligning content with intent. *See* Chapter 6.

15. **Enumerate briefly on the best practices for creating compelling and shareable content on social media platforms to increase brand visibility and engagement.** (SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q3b — 8 M)
Apply the seven-point quality gate; lead with visuals (visual content is far more likely to be shared, and posts with relevant images earn substantially more views); follow the 4-1-1 rule so that value outweighs promotion; write for the platform rather than cross-posting blindly; hook in the first three seconds; use one or two targeted hashtags; post consistently at audience-active times; invite participation through questions, polls and contests; repurpose one master asset into many formats; and amplify through communities and influencers. *See* § 7.5 and § 8.7. *The 4-1-1 rule and the platform-specific practices belong to Unit II; this question is set from Unit I in the paper but answered across both.*

How Unit I Is Examined

THE PATTERN ACROSS PAPERS

In the Semester End Examination, Question 2 is compulsory and is always drawn from Unit I — two sub-divisions of eight marks each — plus roughly two Part A objective questions. In the first Continuous Internal Evaluation test, Unit I typically carries the whole paper.

The three highest-probability ten-mark topics are the eight-step content marketing strategy applied to a scenario, buyer persona creation, and traditional against digital marketing with a transition plan. All three have already repeated across multiple papers.

APPENDIX C

Supplementary Examined Topics

WHAT THIS APPENDIX IS, AND WHY IT IS NOT A CHAPTER

The three topics below appear in past papers for this course but sit outside the literal wording of the Unit I syllabus descriptor — and, in fact, outside the wording of any of the five descriptors. They are placed in an appendix rather than in a numbered chapter so that the rule governing this series is not broken: *the numbered chapters carry the syllabus and nothing else*. They are included rather than dropped because they are genuinely examined, and a student who skipped them would lose real marks.

C.1 The Product Life Cycle

Every product follows a largely inevitable path from launch to eventual disappearance, and the stage a product occupies constrains its content and channel decisions — which is why the topic appears in the supplementary lecture material for this unit.

C.1.1 Diagnosing the stage

- **Market volatility** — are rapid industry shifts limiting the product's lifespan, or favouring new and improved alternatives?
- **Consumer behaviour** — is the product an everyday necessity? Does it solve a common problem? Is its usage simple or complex?
- **Competitive landscape** — how easily can competitors replicate it? Map the number of rivals, their expertise, pricing and distribution channels.

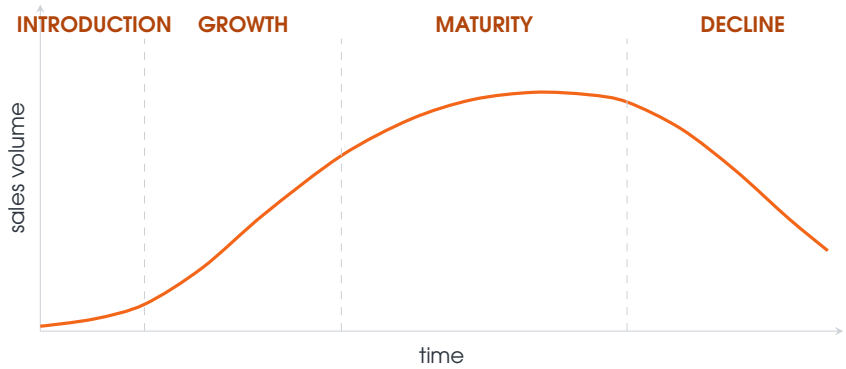


Figure C.1. The product life cycle. Maturity is normally the longest stage, and the curve's shape is not fixed — see § C.1.3.

C.1.2 The master lifecycle matrix

Table C.1. The product life cycle matrix

	Introduction	Growth	Maturity	Decline
Sales volume	Low	Surging	Stabilising	Dropping
Competition	Non-existent	Increasing	Entrenched	Dominating
Primary goal	Create awareness and generate demand	Build market share and loyalty	Defend position and maximise profit	Minimise losses
Core strategy	Promotions and demonstrations	Customisation and expansion	Diversification and cross-selling	Niche focus and liquidation
Historical example	Apple iPhone (2007)	Zara (1990s–2000s)	Kellogg's	Kodak (1990s–2012)

C.1.3 Stage tactics, and why the curve is not always linear

Introduction Consumers are unfamiliar; demand is low while production and distribution costs are high. Offer targeted promotions, discounts and free samples; host product demonstrations to prove functional value; deploy influencer marketing for immediate social proof; use mass media advertising; create shareable brand experiences. *Apple, 2007:* massive television advertising plus a limited initial release and heavily promoted exclusivity generated unprecedented demand.

Growth Sales and profits surge as competitors flood the market. Introduce product customisation; deliver exceptional customer service to lock in loyalty; identify new segments and expand geographically. *Zara:* rapid international expansion while producing small quantities of exclusive designs, creating permanent novelty.

Maturity The longest stage; growth slows, competitors are entrenched and prices fall. Diversify product lines; drive cross-selling with complementary goods; innovate continuously through formula or feature updates; deploy value-based content marketing; compete on cost by optimising production and sourcing. *Kellogg's:* competitor-comparison advertising, organic lines, and cereal bundled with dried fruit and snack bars.

Decline Demand drops as technology or trends shift. Focus on a smaller, highly profitable niche; reposition the brand for new segments; cut marketing spend and rely on organic channels; implement deep cost reductions and discounting; execute exit strategies. *Kodak:* cut prices, diversified into digital printing and sold patents, yet still filed for bankruptcy — proving that some technological shifts are irreversible.

Three deviations from the standard curve are worth naming.

- **Short life** — fad products that spike and die without ever reaching maturity.
- **Extended life** — core staples that plateau and dominate profitably for decades.
- **The pivot** — products that reset their own curve through radical repositioning or new-market expansion.

C.2 Pricing Strategies

MODEL ANSWER — 8 MARKS

(SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q2b — 8 M) Ten strategies, each with an example. Naming and explaining any six or seven with examples is normally sufficient at eight marks.

Table C.2. Pricing strategies

Strategy	Basis	Example
Penetration pricing	A low launch price to win share fast	Jio's initial free and low tariffs
Skimming pricing	A high launch price harvested from early adopters, then lowered	New smartphone flagship models
Cost-plus pricing	Cost plus a fixed markup	Retail and FMCG distribution
Value-based pricing	Priced on perceived customer value rather than cost	Premium software, luxury goods
Competitive or going-rate pricing	Matched to rivals	Airlines, fuel
Psychological pricing	Prices set just below a round number	Rs. 999 instead of Rs. 1,000
Bundle pricing	Several items priced together below their sum	Combo packs, office software suites
Freemium	A free core product with a paid upgrade	Streaming and conferencing services
Dynamic pricing	Real-time adjustment by demand	Ride-hailing surge pricing, large marketplaces
Promotional or discount pricing	Temporary reductions to drive volume	Festival mega-sale events

C.3 Market Segmentation Against the Marketing Mix

DEFINITION • Market Segmentation

Market segmentation is the process of dividing a heterogeneous total market into smaller homogeneous groups of buyers with similar needs, on bases such as geographic, demographic, psychographic and behavioural, so that each group can be targeted distinctly.

The distinction the examiner wants is one of *function*, and it reduces to one line.

THE ONE-LINE DISTINCTION

Segmentation decides whom to serve. The marketing mix decides how to serve them. (SEE, Oct/Nov 2023 — 2 M)

Segmentation is an analytical, prior decision about the market; the mix is a set of controllable tactical levers applied after that decision has been taken. Changing the segment changes every element of the mix, but changing the mix does not change the segment.

APPENDIX D

Glossary of Key Terms

Table D.1. Key terms for rapid revision

Term	One-line meaning
Affiliate marketing	Performance-based marketing paying partners for traffic, leads or sales actually delivered
Bounce rate	The percentage of visitors who leave after viewing only one page without interaction
Brand	An offering from a known source
Buyer persona	A research-based, semi-fictional profile of the ideal customer
Call to action (CTA)	The explicit instruction telling the visitor what to do next
Content marketing	Creating and distributing valuable, relevant, consistent content to drive profitable customer action
Demands	Wants for a specific product backed by ability and willingness to pay
Digital marketing	Targeted, conversion-oriented, quantifiable, interactive marketing using digital technologies
Earned media	Reach the audience gives you and you did not pay for
Holistic marketing	The view that everything matters in marketing: internal, integrated, performance and relationship marketing
Influencer	An early-adopter online opinion leader who holds the virtual ear of the masses
Landing page	A single-purpose page a campaign sends traffic to, built for one conversion
Mantra of marketing	Create, Communicate, Deliver, Value, Target, Profit
Marketing management	Choosing target markets and getting, keeping and growing customers through superior customer value
Marketing mix	The controllable tactical tools: Product, Price, Place, Promotion
Marketplace	A physical or digital location where exchange occurs
Market space	A virtual environment in which value is created digitally
Message match	The correspondence between an advertisement and the landing page it leads to
Metamarket	A cluster of complementary products and services related in the consumer's mind but spread across industries
Needs	Basic human requirements, not created by marketers
Offering	The combination of products, services, information and experiences that delivers the value proposition
Owned media	Assets entirely controlled by the brand
Paid media	Reach bought with capital, which ends when spending ends

Term	One-line meaning
Perceived anonymity	The online trait that frees consumers from real-world social constraint
Product life cycle	Introduction, growth, maturity, decline
Prosumer	A consumer who also shapes or produces what they consume
Pull marketing	The customer actively seeks the brand out
Push marketing	The brand pushes the product towards the customer
QSP triad	Quality, service and price — the components of value
Satisficing	Choosing the first option that plausibly works rather than the best one
Satisfaction	A person's judgement of perceived performance against expectations
Share of voice	Conversation about your brand as a proportion of conversation about the category
Value proposition	The set of benefits a firm offers to satisfy a customer need
Wants	Needs directed at specific objects, shaped by society and personality

APPENDIX E

Framework Quick-Reference Sheet

Everything in this volume that is a numbered list, in one place, for the night before the examination.

Table E.1. Framework quick reference

Framework	The sequence
Mantra of marketing	Create → Communicate → Deliver → Value → Target → Profit
Ten marketable entities	Goods, services, events, experiences, persons, places, properties, organizations, information, ideas
Core concepts	Needs, wants, demands, value, exchange, markets
Value creation engine	Audience → solution → result
Satisfaction rule	Performance below expectation dissatisfies; equal satisfies; above delights
Five company orientations	Production, product, selling, marketing, holistic
Holistic marketing	Internal, integrated, performance, relationship
Eight management tasks	Strategies and plans, insights, connecting, brands, creating, delivering, communicating, long-term growth
Marketing mix	Product, Price, Place, Promotion (+ People, Process, Physical evidence; mirrored by the four Cs)
Technology adoption pattern	Emergence → foothold → exploration → mainstream
Five online consumer traits	Comfortable, want it now, in control, fickle, vocal
Five strategy pillars	Know your business, the competition, your customers, your goals, your results
Seven governing principles	Measurability, interactivity, personalisation, permission, integration, iteration, content centrality
Media taxonomy	Owned (foundation), paid (accelerator), earned (validator)
Persona process	Research customers → segment → gather data → identify goals and pain points → build and validate
Persona canvas	Background and goals; information sources; messaging and topics; purchase role and objections
Competitor decisions	Emulate, avoid, occupy
Website analysis halves	Technical health; behavioural insight
Content quality gate	Credible, shareable, useful or fun, interesting, relevant, different, on-brand
Elite content marketer traits	Documented strategy, dedicated leadership, expanded tactics, multi-platform distribution, budget allocation

Framework	The sequence
Eight content steps	Goals → audience → ideation → creation → distribution → amplification → evaluation → improvement
Three content phases	Architecture, mechanics, telemetry
Audience mapping layers	Anxieties and desires → pain points → profile and persona
Content plan layers	Strategic, structural, temporal → road map
Amplification nodes	Communities, buzzers, influencers
5A customer path	Aware, appeal, ask, act, advocate — visible, relatable, searchable, actionable, shareable
Content flywheel	Audience research → keyword strategy → creation → distribution → measurement → repeat
Seven usability attributes	Useful, learnable, memorable, effective, efficient, desirable, delightful
Billboard design rules	Visual hierarchy, omit needless words, obvious clickables, breadcrumbs and street signs
Three metric buckets	Reach and visibility; resonance and memory; engagement and friction
Five content metrics	Traffic, engagement rate, bounce rate, lead generation, conversion rate and ROI
KPI alignment	Identify goals → map to KPIs → make SMART → instrument analytics → optimise continuously
Keyword sweet spot	High volume × low difficulty × commercial intent
Product life cycle	Introduction, growth, maturity, decline

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